

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

President and Vice President - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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President and Vice President - Complete Uncompressed Learning Session

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** 15 | **GS-II + Prelims** | **Export date:** 2026-08-16 **Approval:** false - awaiting explicit user approval. **Evidence key:** [FACT] constitutional, judicial or officially verified proposition; [ANALYSIS] reasoned exam synthesis; [CURRENT] dated status; [LIMIT] qualification preventing overstatement.

Package method, scope boundary and current control

- Source order followed: certified Core owner Polity/basic/President-and-Vice-President.md -> optional Advanced owner Polity/advanced/15_President-and-Vice-President.md -> comparative Core for France/USA -> official local PYQ scans and 2025 official Set-A key -> live official constitutional-office controls -> Qdrant not used.
- [LIMIT] Foundation and Core are independently answer-complete. Optional Advanced adds theory, comparisons and deeper institutional criticism only.
- [CURRENT] Status is controlled to **24 August 2026, Asia/Kolkata**.
- [CURRENT] **Live official refresh, 24 August 2026:** The official office websites accessed 24 August 2026 identify Droupadi Murmu as President and C. P. Radhakrishnan as Vice-President.
- [CURRENT] **Droupadi Murmu** is the 15th President of India, in office since 25 July 2022.
- [CURRENT] **C. P. Radhakrishnan** is the 15th Vice-President of India, in office since 12 September 2025.
- [CURRENT] His 2025 election followed a casual vacancy. Article 68 requires that election **as soon as possible** and gives the successor a fresh five-year term; it does **not** prescribe the President's six-month casual-vacancy deadline.
- [CURRENT] The Supreme Court's 20 November 2025 Article 143 opinion rejected judicially invented rigid assent timelines and deemed assent under Articles 200/201, while allowing limited intervention against glaring, prolonged and unexplained inaction.
- Package target: **8 routed PYQs, 28 original MCQs, 8 remedials, 7 solved Mains questions and 14 original visuals**.

Roadmap

Stage	Coverage	Exam outcome
Architecture	Nominal President, presiding Vice-President	Understands office design
President election	College, vote value, STV, disputes	Solves repeated Prelims route
Conditions	Qualifications, oath, term, vacancy, immunity	Controls close options
Removal	Article 61 impeachment	Distinguishes election and removal bodies
Position	Articles 53, 74, 75 and situational discretion	Answers "rubber stamp" demands
Powers	Executive, legislative, financial, judicial and external	Builds complete Mains body
Veto/ordinance	Articles 111, 123 and 201	Handles executive-legislation traps
Clemency	Article 72, Article 161 contrast and review	Solves 2025 Prelims/Mains
Vice-President	Election, removal, vacancy and acting role	Prevents President-VP mixing
Rajya Sabha Chair	Rules, casting vote, defection and neutrality	Answers 2022 GS-II
Comparison	India-France election and India-USA pardon	Answers 2022/2025 GS-II
Practice	Eight PYQs, 36 MCQs and seven Mains models	Converts knowledge into marks

Scope ownership and cross-links

- **Polity 11:** parliamentary-government logic and collective responsibility.
- **Polity 14:** presidential Emergency powers.
- **Polity 16:** Prime Minister and Council of Ministers.
- **Polity 17:** Parliament, Money Bills, sessions and presiding officers.
- **Polity 19:** Governor, Article 161 and Article 200.
- **Comparative Constitutional Schemes:** complete French election and US pardon comparison.
- [LIMIT] Cross-linking avoids duplication; every President-Vice-President-specific rule remains complete here.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - TWO OFFICES, TWO CONSTITUTIONAL PURPOSES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Two offices, two constitutional purposes denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Dimension President Vice-President.

Technical definition: The offices are not a succession hierarchy in the US sense.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Constitution does not use "nominal executive" as a label; that conclusion follows from Articles 53, 74 and 75 and parliamentary practice.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

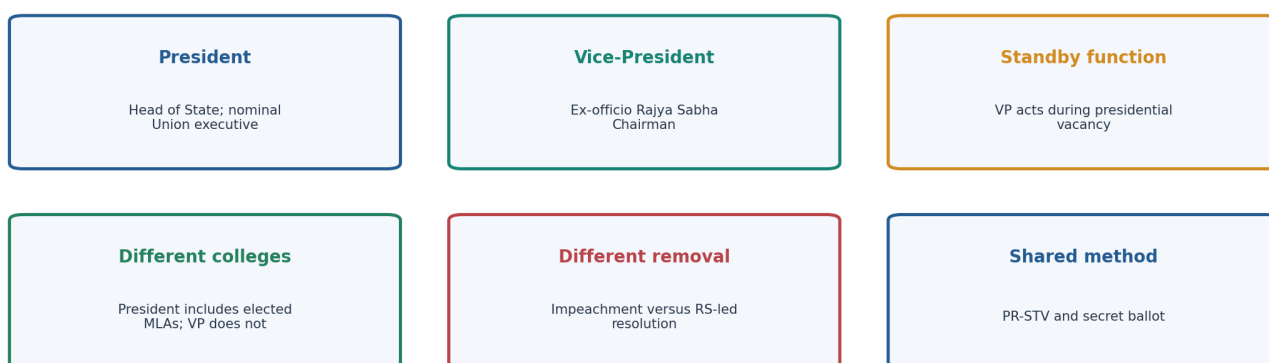
- Two offices
- two constitutional purposes
- Articles

- **Core position**
- **Ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha**
- **52-62; powers across Constitution, including 72**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Two offices; define two constitutional purposes, connect Articles with Core position to explain the mechanism, and use Ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Two offices, two constitutional purposes denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Dimension President Vice-President. Two offices, two constitutional purposes operates through Articles 52-62; powers across Constitution, including 72 63-71; Chairmanship also under 64, 89, 92 and 100, connected with Core position Head of State; Union executive power formally vested in office Ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha. The operative mechanism matters because election base Elected MPs plus specified elected MLAs Members of both Houses of Parliament. Its principal consequence is that normal executive authority Acts on ministerial advice No ordinary Union executive power. The decisive contrast is between Removal Impeachment for violation of Constitution Rajya Sabha-initiated removal; no ground stated and Standby role Office must always exist Acts as President during vacancy/temporary inability. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] Article 52 says there shall be a President of India; Article 63 similarly creates a Vice-President.

President and Vice-President: constitutional design



The President is the constitutional Head of State; the Vice-President's regular work is chairing the Rajya Sabha.

Dimension	President	Vice-President
Articles	52-62; powers across Constitution, including 72	63-71; Chairmanship also under 64, 89, 92 and 100
Core position	Head of State; Union executive power formally vested in office	Ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha
Election base	Elected MPs plus specified elected MLAs	Members of both Houses of Parliament
Normal executive authority	Acts on ministerial advice	No ordinary Union executive power
Removal	Impeachment for violation of Constitution	Rajya Sabha-initiated removal; no ground stated
Standby role	Office must always exist	Acts as President during vacancy/temporary inability

- [FACT] Article 52 says there shall be a President of India; Article 63 similarly creates a Vice-President.
- [ANALYSIS] The offices are not a succession hierarchy in the US sense. The Vice-President temporarily acts; he or she does not inherit the remainder of a presidential term.
- [LIMIT] The Constitution does not use "nominal executive" as a label; that conclusion follows from Articles 53, 74 and 75 and parliamentary practice.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - TWO OFFICES, TWO CONSTITUTIONAL PURPOSES

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | Two offices, two constitutional purposes

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

Two offices · two constitutional purposes · Articles · Core position · Ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha · 52-62; powers across Constitution, including 72

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The decisive contrast is between Removal Impeachment for violation of Constitution Rajya Sabha-initiated removal; no ground stated and Standby role Office must always exist Acts as President during vacancy/temporary inability.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The offices are not a succession hierarchy in the US sense.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

The Constitution does not use "nominal executive" as a label; that conclusion follows from Articles 53, 74 and 75 and parliamentary practice.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Constitution does not use "nominal executive" as a label; that conclusion follows from Articles 53, 74 and 75 and parliamentary practice.

SESSION 2 - ELECTION OF THE PRESIDENT: WHO VOTES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Election of the President: who votes denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Elected members of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha.

Technical definition: The President is democratically elected but does not possess a direct popular mandate against the Council of Ministers.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Weighted State votes provide a federal element while equal MP vote value binds the Union side into one national college.

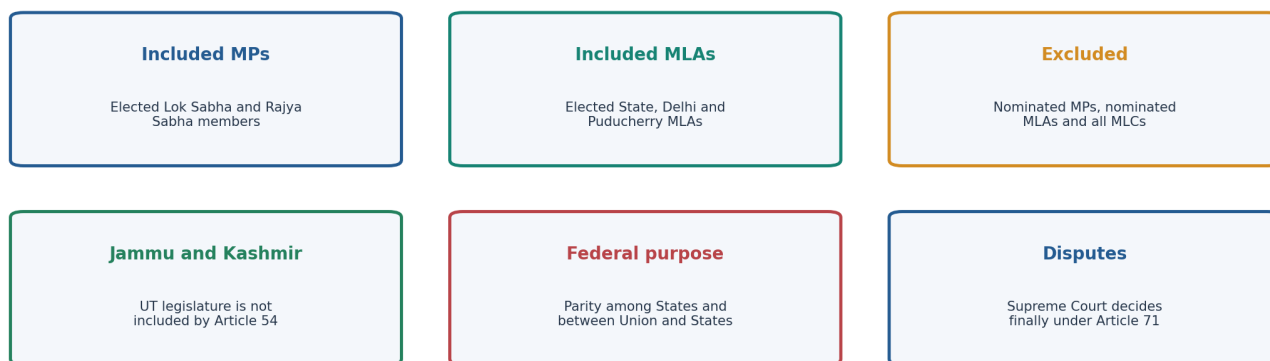
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Election of the President
- who votes
- Article 54
- Election of the President: who votes
- Election
- President

How to use them: Frame the answer through Election of the President; define who votes, connect Article 54 with Election of the President: who votes to explain the mechanism, and use Election for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Election of the President: who votes denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] Elected members of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha. Election of the President: who votes operates through [FACT] Elected members of the Legislative Assemblies of the States, connected with [FACT] Nominated members of either House of Parliament. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] Nominated members of State/eligible UT Assemblies. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] Every member of a State Legislative Council. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] Jammu and Kashmir's UT legislature is not added to the Article 54 explanation, which names only Delhi and Puducherry and [ANALYSIS] Indirect election fits a parliamentary system in which the President normally lacks an independent executive programme. The exam-safe limitation is that [ANALYSIS] Weighted State votes provide a federal element while equal MP vote value binds the Union side into one national college.

Presidential electoral college



The presidential college combines elected Union and State representatives but excludes nominated and upper-State-house members.

Included

- [FACT] Elected members of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha.
- [FACT] Elected members of the Legislative Assemblies of the States.
- [FACT] Elected members of the Legislative Assemblies of the National Capital Territory of Delhi and Puducherry, added through the 70th Amendment framework.

Excluded

- [FACT] Nominated members of either House of Parliament.
- [FACT] Nominated members of State/eligible UT Assemblies.
- [FACT] Every member of a State Legislative Council.
- [FACT] Jammu and Kashmir's UT legislature is not added to the Article 54 explanation, which names only Delhi and Puducherry.

Why indirect

- [ANALYSIS] Indirect election fits a parliamentary system in which the President normally lacks an independent executive programme.
- [ANALYSIS] Weighted State votes provide a federal element while equal MP vote value binds the Union side into one national college.
- [LIMIT] The President is democratically elected but does not possess a direct popular mandate against the Council of Ministers.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ELECTION OF THE PRESIDENT: WHO VOTES

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Election of the President: who votes			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Election of the President · who votes · Article 54 · Election of the President: who votes · Election · President	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT The decisive contrast is between Jammu and Kashmir's UT legislature is not added to the Article 54 explanation, which names only Delhi and Puducherry and Indirect election fits a parliamentary system in which the President normally lacks an independent executive programme.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The President is democratically elected but does not possess a direct popular mandate against the Council of Ministers.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE The exam-safe limitation is that Weighted State votes provide a federal element while equal MP vote value binds the Union side into one national college.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Weighted State votes provide a federal element while equal MP vote value binds the Union side into one national college.			

SESSION 3 - VOTE VALUE, PARITY AND PR-STV

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Vote value, parity and PR-STV denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around State population / (elected MLAs x 1000).

Technical definition: Vote value, parity and PR-STV operates through If the remaining fraction is at least 500, one is added to the quotient, connected with "Population" continues to use the 1971 census until relevant figures of the first census taken after 2026 have been published.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Weighted MLA votes preserve interstate population balance, equal MP vote values balance Parliament with the States, and PR-STV converts ranked preferences into a majority mandate for one office.

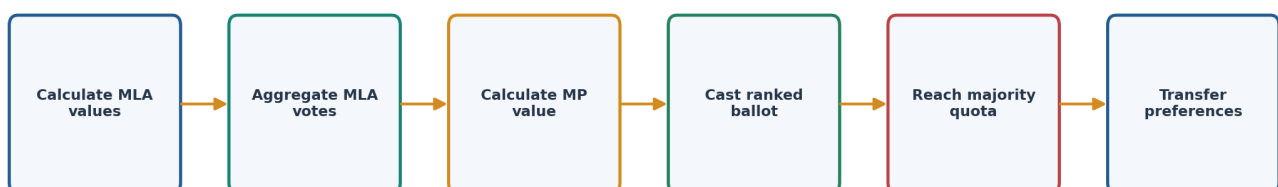
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Vote value**
- **parity**
- **PR-STV**
- **Vote value, parity and PR-STV**
- **Vote**
- **MLAs**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Vote value; define parity, connect PR-STV with Vote value, parity and PR-STV to explain the mechanism, and use Vote for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Vote value, parity and PR-STV denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around State population / (elected MLAs x 1000). Vote value, parity and PR-STV operates through [FACT] If the remaining fraction is at least 500, one is added to the quotient, connected with [FACT] "Population" continues to use the 1971 census until relevant figures of the first census taken after 2026 have been published. The operative mechanism matters because total value of votes of all elected MLAs / total elected MPs of both Houses. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] Every elected MP, whether from Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha, has the same vote value. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] Fractions exceeding one-half are counted as one; other fractions are disregarded and [FACT] Election uses proportional representation by single transferable vote and secret ballot. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] Electors rank candidates. The winning quota is more than half the total valid vote value.

How a President is elected



Weighted vote values seek parity; ranked preferences then produce a majority-supported winner.

MLA vote value

State population / (elected MLAs x 1000)

- [FACT] If the remaining fraction is at least 500, one is added to the quotient.

- [FACT] "Population" continues to use the 1971 census until relevant figures of the first census taken after 2026 have been published.
- [ANALYSIS] More Assembly seats do not by themselves raise each MLA's value; the decisive quantity is the population-to-elected-MLA ratio.

MP vote value

Total value of votes of all elected MLAs / total elected MPs of both Houses

- [FACT] Every elected MP, whether from Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha, has the same vote value.
- [FACT] Fractions exceeding one-half are counted as one; other fractions are disregarded.

Ballot and count

- [FACT] Election uses proportional representation by single transferable vote and secret ballot.
- [FACT] Electors rank candidates. The winning quota is more than half the total valid vote value.
- [FACT] If nobody reaches the quota on first preferences, the lowest candidate is excluded and transferable values move according to next preferences.
- [LIMIT] "Proportional representation" here elects one office; its practical effect is majority preference through transferable rankings, not a multi-seat proportional legislature.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - VOTE VALUE, PARITY AND PR-STV

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Vote value, parity and PR-STV			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Vote value · parity · PR-STV · Vote value, parity and PR-STV · Vote · MLAs	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Vote value, parity and PR-STV operates through If the remaining fraction is at least 500, one is added to the quotient, connected with "Population" continues to use the 1971 census until relevant figures of the first census taken after 2026 have been published.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Its principal consequence is that Every elected MP, whether from Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha, has the same vote value.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: the decisive contrast is between Fractions exceeding one-half are counted as one.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Weighted MLA votes preserve interstate population balance, equal MP vote values balance Parliament with the States, and PR-STV converts ranked preferences into a majority mandate for one office.			

SESSION 4 - PRESIDENTIAL ELECTION ADMINISTRATION AND DISPUTES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Presidential election administration and disputes denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around A candidate needs 50 proposers and 50 seconders and a statutory deposit of Rs 15,000.

Technical definition: Presidential election administration and disputes operates through Acts already done in office are not invalidated merely because the election is later declared void, connected with An election cannot be challenged merely because the electoral college contained a vacancy for any reason.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Dissolution of some State Assemblies does not constitutionally justify postponing the presidential election.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Presidential election administration
- disputes
- Rs 15,000
- Article 71
- Presidential election administration and disputes
- 50 proposers and 50 seconders

How to use them: Frame the answer through Presidential election administration; define disputes, connect Rs 15,000 with Article 71 to explain the mechanism, and use Presidential election administration and disputes for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Presidential election administration and disputes denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] A candidate needs 50 proposers and 50 seconders and a statutory deposit of Rs 15,000. Presidential election administration and disputes operates through [FACT] Acts already done in office are not invalidated merely because the election is later declared void, connected with [FACT] An election cannot be challenged merely because the electoral college contained a vacancy for any reason. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] Dissolution of some State Assemblies does not constitutionally justify postponing the presidential election. Its principal consequence is that [ANALYSIS] These rules protect continuity of the Head of State while preserving judicial control over the election itself. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] A candidate needs 50 proposers and 50 seconders and a statutory deposit of Rs 15,000 and [FACT] A candidate needs 50 proposers and 50 seconders and a statutory deposit of Rs 15,000. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] A candidate needs 50 proposers and 50 seconders and a statutory deposit of Rs 15,000.

- [FACT] A candidate needs **50 proposers and 50 seconders** and a statutory deposit of **Rs 15,000**.
- [FACT] The Supreme Court finally decides doubts and disputes connected with election of the President or Vice-President under Article 71.
- [FACT] Acts already done in office are not invalidated merely because the election is later declared void.
- [FACT] An election cannot be challenged merely because the electoral college contained a vacancy for any reason.
- [FACT] Dissolution of some State Assemblies does not constitutionally justify postponing the presidential election.
- [ANALYSIS] These rules protect continuity of the Head of State while preserving judicial control over the election itself.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PRESIDENTIAL ELECTION ADMINISTRATION AND DISPUTES

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Presidential election administration and disputes			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Presidential election administration · disputes · Rs 15,000 · Article 71 · Presidential election administration and disputes · 50 proposers and 50 seconders	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Presidential election administration and disputes operates through Acts already done in office are not invalidated merely because the election is later declared void, connected with An election cannot be challenged merely because the electoral college contained a vacancy for any reason.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The operative mechanism matters because Dissolution of some State Assemblies does not constitutionally justify postponing the presidential election.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Dissolution of some State Assemblies does not constitutionally justify postponing the presidential election.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dissolution of some State Assemblies does not constitutionally justify postponing the presidential election.			

SESSION 5 - QUALIFICATIONS, OATH AND CONDITIONS OF OFFICE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Qualifications, oath and conditions of office denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Citizenship Citizen of India.

Technical definition: For qualification, holding office as President, Vice-President, Governor or Union/State minister is not treated as holding an office of profit.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The President is entitled to the official residence and statutory emoluments; these cannot be diminished during the term.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Qualifications**
- **oath**
- **conditions of office**

- **Citizenship**
- **Citizen of India**
- **Minimum age**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Qualifications; define oath, connect conditions of office with Citizenship to explain the mechanism, and use Citizen of India for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Qualifications, oath and conditions of office denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Citizenship Citizen of India. Qualifications, oath and conditions of office operates through Minimum age 35 years, connected with Electoral qualification Qualified for election as a Lok Sabha member. The operative mechanism matters because office of profit Must not hold one under Union, State or controlled local/other authority. Its principal consequence is that oath CJI, or in absence the senior-most available Supreme Court judge. The decisive contrast is between Legislative membership If an MP/MLA is elected, the seat is deemed vacated on entering office and [FACT] The President is entitled to the official residence and statutory emoluments; these cannot be diminished during the term. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] The oath promises faithful execution, preservation/protection/defence of the Constitution and law, and service to the people.

Test	President
Citizenship	Citizen of India
Minimum age	35 years
Electoral qualification	Qualified for election as a Lok Sabha member
Office of profit	Must not hold one under Union, State or controlled local/other authority
Oath	CJI, or in absence the senior-most available Supreme Court judge
Legislative membership	If an MP/MLA is elected, the seat is deemed vacated on entering office

- [FACT] For qualification, holding office as President, Vice-President, Governor or Union/State minister is not treated as holding an office of profit.
- [FACT] The President is entitled to the official residence and statutory emoluments; these cannot be diminished during the term.
- [FACT] The oath promises faithful execution, preservation/protection/defence of the Constitution and law, and service to the people.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - QUALIFICATIONS, OATH AND CONDITIONS OF OFFICE

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Qualifications, oath and conditions of office			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Qualifications · oath · conditions of office · Citizenship · Citizen of India · Minimum age	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT The operative mechanism matters because office of profit Must not hold one under Union, State or controlled local/other authority.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST For qualification, holding office as President, Vice-President, Governor or Union/State minister is not treated as holding an office of profit.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: its principal consequence is that oath CJI, or in absence the senior-most available Supreme...
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The President is entitled to the official residence and statutory emoluments; these cannot be diminished during the term.			

SESSION 6 - TERM, RE-ELECTION, VACANCY AND SUCCESSION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Term, re-election, vacancy and succession operates through The President may resign to the Vice-President, connected with The President remains in office after the five years until the successor enters office; there is no ordinary interregnum.

Technical definition: Term, re-election, vacancy and succession denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around The term is five years from entering office.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Presidential continuity avoids an ordinary interregnum, while a casual-vacancy election must occur within six months and gives the successor a fresh five-year term.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Term
- re-election
- vacancy
- succession
- Term, re-election, vacancy and succession
- The President

How to use them: Frame the answer through Term; define re-election, connect vacancy with succession to explain the mechanism, and use Term, re-election, vacancy and succession for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Term, re-election, vacancy and succession denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] The term is five years from entering office. Term, re-election, vacancy and succession operates through [FACT] The President may resign to the Vice-President, connected with [FACT] The President remains in office after the five years until the successor enters office; there is no ordinary interregnum. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] Re-election is constitutionally unlimited. Dr Rajendra Prasad alone completed two presidential terms. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] Election to fill an expected expiry must be completed before expiry. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] The term is five years from entering office and [FACT] The term is five years from entering office. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] The term is five years from entering office.

Presidential lifecycle



The Constitution separates normal expiry, continuation until a successor and a six-month casual-vacancy election.

- [FACT] The term is five years from entering office.
- [FACT] The President may resign to the Vice-President.
- [FACT] The President remains in office after the five years until the successor enters office; there is no ordinary interregnum.
- [FACT] Re-election is constitutionally unlimited. Dr Rajendra Prasad alone completed two presidential terms.
- [FACT] Election to fill an expected expiry must be completed before expiry.
- [FACT] A casual vacancy caused by death, resignation, removal or otherwise must be filled within six months; the elected successor receives a fresh five-year term.
- [FACT] The Vice-President acts as President during a vacancy. If both offices are unavailable, Parliament's law places the Chief Justice of India, or the senior-most available Supreme Court judge, in the acting role.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - TERM, RE-ELECTION, VACANCY AND SUCCESSION

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | Term, re-election, vacancy and succession

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

Term · re-election · vacancy · succession · Term, re-election, vacancy and succession · The President

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Term, re-election, vacancy and succession denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around The term is five years from entering office.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The decisive contrast is between The term is five years from entering office and The term is five years from entering office.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not miss this limiting distinction: a casual vacancy caused by death, resignation, removal or otherwise must be filled within...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Presidential continuity avoids an ordinary interregnum, while a casual-vacancy election must occur within six months and gives the successor a fresh five-year term.

SESSION 7 - IMPEACHMENT UNDER ARTICLE 61

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Impeachment under Article 61 denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around The sole ground is violation of the Constitution , which the Constitution does not define.

Technical definition: Impeachment under Article 61 operates through Either House may initiate, connected with At least one-fourth of the total membership of the initiating House must sign the notice; at least 14 days' notice is required.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nominated MPs may participate in impeachment although they do not elect the President; State MLAs elect but do not impeach.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Impeachment under Article 61
- violation of the Constitution
- Article 61
- Impeachment
- Article
- Constitution

How to use them: Frame the answer through Impeachment under Article 61; define violation of the Constitution, connect Article 61 with Impeachment to explain the mechanism, and use Article for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Impeachment under Article 61 denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] The sole ground is violation of the Constitution , which the Constitution does not define. Impeachment under Article 61 operates through [FACT] Either House may initiate, connected with [FACT] At least one-fourth of the total membership of the initiating House must sign the notice; at least 14 days' notice is required. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] The initiating House must pass the charge by at least two-thirds of its total membership. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] The other House investigates or causes investigation. The President has the right to appear and be represented. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] If the investigating House also sustains the charge by two-thirds of its total membership, removal takes effect on passage and [FACT] Nominated MPs may participate in impeachment although they do not elect the President; State MLAs elect but do not impeach. The exam-safe limitation is that [CURRENT] No Indian President has been impeached.

Article 61 impeachment



Impeachment is a two-House quasi-judicial process requiring two-thirds of total membership at both decisive stages.

- [FACT] The sole ground is **violation of the Constitution**, which the Constitution does not define.
- [FACT] Either House may initiate.
- [FACT] At least one-fourth of the total membership of the initiating House must sign the notice; at least 14 days' notice is required.
- [FACT] The initiating House must pass the charge by at least two-thirds of its total membership.
- [FACT] The other House investigates or causes investigation. The President has the right to appear and be represented.
- [FACT] If the investigating House also sustains the charge by two-thirds of its total membership, removal takes effect on passage.
- [FACT] Nominated MPs may participate in impeachment although they do not elect the President; State MLAs elect but do not impeach.
- [CURRENT] No Indian President has been impeached.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - IMPEACHMENT UNDER ARTICLE 61

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Impeachment under Article 61			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Impeachment under Article 61 · violation of the Constitution · Article 61 · Impeachment · Article · Constitution	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Impeachment under Article 61 operates through Either House may initiate, connected with At least one-fourth of the total membership of the initiating House must sign the notice; at least 14 days' notice is required.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Nominated MPs may participate in impeachment although they do not elect the President; State MLAs elect but do not impeach. [CURRENT] No Indian President has been impeached.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE The sole ground is violation of the Constitution, which the Constitution does not define.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nominated MPs may participate in impeachment although they do not elect the President; State MLAs elect but do not impeach.			

SESSION 8 - PRESIDENTIAL IMMUNITIES UNDER ARTICLE 361

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Presidential immunities under Article 361 denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during the term.

Technical definition: Presidential immunities under Article 361 operates through No arrest or imprisonment process may issue during the term, connected with Immunity of the person does not place government action beyond judicial review.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The President is not answerable to any court for official acts, subject to parliamentary investigation of an impeachment charge and the ability to sue the Union where law permits.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Presidential immunities under Article 361
- Article 361
- Presidential
- Article
- No
- Immunity

How to use them: Frame the answer through Presidential immunities under Article 361; define Article 361, connect Presidential with Article to explain the mechanism, and use No for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Presidential immunities under Article 361 denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during the term. Presidential immunities under Article 361 operates through [FACT] No arrest or imprisonment process may issue during the term, connected with [LIMIT] Immunity of the person does not place government action beyond judicial review. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during the term. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during the term. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during the term and [FACT] No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during the term. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during the term.

- [FACT] The President is not answerable to any court for official acts, subject to parliamentary investigation of an impeachment charge and the ability to sue the Union where law permits.
- [FACT] No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during the term.
- [FACT] No arrest or imprisonment process may issue during the term.
- [FACT] Civil proceedings concerning personal acts may begin during the term only after two months' written notice containing the prescribed particulars.
- [LIMIT] Immunity of the person does not place government action beyond judicial review.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PRESIDENTIAL IMMUNITIES UNDER ARTICLE 361

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Presidential immunities under Article 361			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Presidential immunities under Article 361 · Article 361 · Presidential · Article · No · Immunity	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Presidential immunities under Article 361 denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during the term.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Immunity of the person does not place government action beyond judicial review.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: its principal consequence is that No criminal proceeding may be instituted or continued during...
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The President is not answerable to any court for official acts, subject to parliamentary investigation of an impeachment charge and the ability to sue the Union where law permits.			

SESSION 9 - CONSTITUTIONAL POSITION: DIGNITY WITHOUT A RIVAL MANDATE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Constitutional position: dignity without a rival mandate denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Article 53 formally vests Union executive power in the President.

Technical definition: Constitutional position: dignity without a rival mandate operates through Article 74 requires a Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister to aid and advise, connected with The 42nd Amendment made advice expressly binding.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Ambedkar's formula remains exact: the President is head of the State but not the real executive.

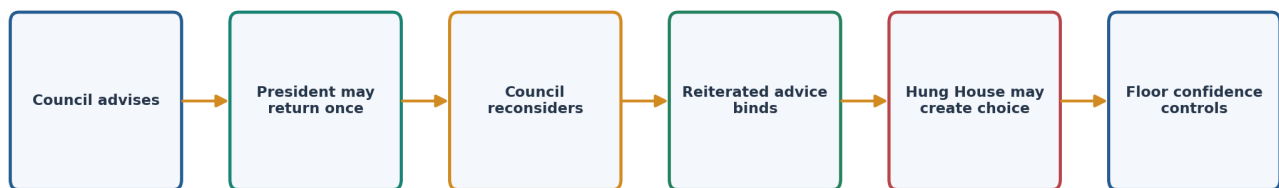
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Constitutional position
- dignity without a rival mandate
- Article 53
- Article 74
- Article 75
- Article 163

How to use them: Frame the answer through Constitutional position; define dignity without a rival mandate, connect Article 53 with Article 74 to explain the mechanism, and use Article 75 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Constitutional position: dignity without a rival mandate denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] Article 53 formally vests Union executive power in the President. Constitutional position: dignity without a rival mandate operates through [FACT] Article 74 requires a Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister to aid and advise, connected with [FACT] The 42nd Amendment made advice expressly binding. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] Article 75 ties the Council's survival to collective responsibility to Lok Sabha. Its principal consequence is that [ANALYSIS] Ambedkar's formula remains exact: the President is head of the State but not the real executive. The decisive contrast is between Situational discretion, not a personal policy power and [ANALYSIS] Requiring a ministry whose majority is credibly disputed to demonstrate confidence on the floor. The exam-safe limitation is that [ANALYSIS] Dismissing a ministry that has lost confidence but refuses to resign.

Advice, reconsideration and situational choice



Ministerial advice binds after reconsideration, but fractured mandates can create narrow situational choices.

- [FACT] Article 53 formally vests Union executive power in the President.
- [FACT] Article 74 requires a Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister to aid and advise.
- [FACT] The 42nd Amendment made advice expressly binding.
- [FACT] The 44th Amendment permits the President to require reconsideration once; advice tendered after reconsideration must be accepted.
- [FACT] Article 75 ties the Council's survival to collective responsibility to Lok Sabha.
- [ANALYSIS] Ambedkar's formula remains exact: the President is head of the State but not the real executive.

Situational discretion, not a personal policy power

- [ANALYSIS] Appointing a Prime Minister when no party has a clear majority, with the objective test being ability to secure Lok Sabha confidence.
- [ANALYSIS] Requiring a ministry whose majority is credibly disputed to demonstrate confidence on the floor.
- [ANALYSIS] Dismissing a ministry that has lost confidence but refuses to resign.
- [ANALYSIS] Considering whether dissolution advice from a defeated/minority ministry should be accepted where an alternative government is demonstrably available.
- [FACT] K. R. Narayanan returned Union Cabinet advice concerning proposed President's Rule in Uttar Pradesh (1997) and Bihar (1998); reiterated advice would have bound him.

- [LIMIT] The President has no general constitutional discretion equivalent to the Governor's Article 163 formulation. Convention, reasoned choice and floor confidence bound each exceptional decision.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CONSTITUTIONAL POSITION: DIGNITY WITHOUT A RIVAL MANDATE

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Constitutional position: dignity without a rival mandate			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Constitutional position · dignity without a rival mandate · Article 53 · Article 74 · Article 75 · Article 163	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Constitutional position: dignity without a rival mandate operates through Article 74 requires a Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister to aid and advise, connected with The 42nd Amendment made advice expressly binding.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Its principal consequence is that Ambedkar's formula remains exact: the President is head of the State but not the real executive.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE The decisive contrast is between Situational discretion, not a personal policy power and Requiring a ministry whose majority is credibly disputed to demonstrate confidence on the floor.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ambedkar's formula remains exact: the President is head of the State but not the real executive.			

SESSION 10 - EXECUTIVE POWERS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Executive powers denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode.

Technical definition: The operative mechanism matters because All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Appointment in the President's name does not mean unfettered personal selection; constitutional provisions, statutes, judicial doctrine and ministerial advice control different offices.

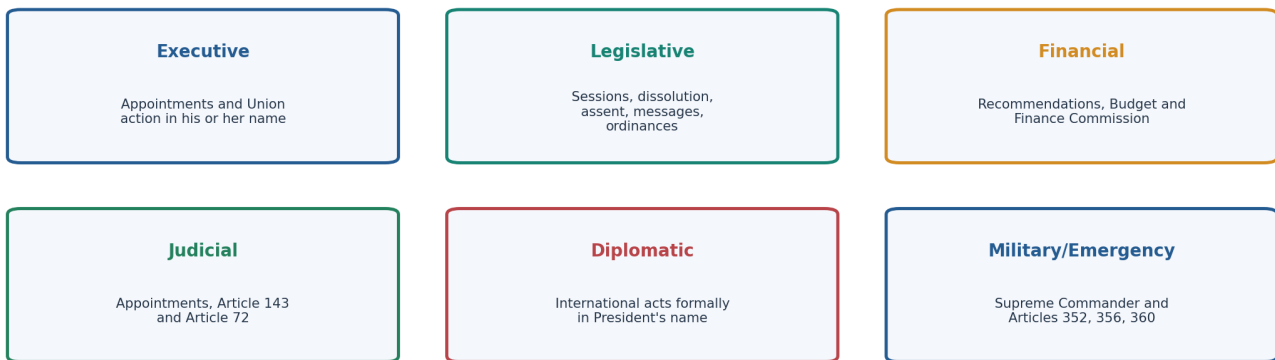
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Executive powers
- Article 77
- Article 78
- Executive
- All Union
- President's

How to use them: Frame the answer through Executive powers; define Article 77, connect Article 78 with Executive to explain the mechanism, and use All Union for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Executive powers denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode. Executive powers operates through [FACT] Appoints the Prime Minister and, on PM advice, other ministers, connected with [FACT] Directly administers Union Territories through administrators to the extent provided by the Constitution. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode and [FACT] All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode.

Seven heads of presidential power



Presidential powers are constitutionally broad in form and ordinarily ministerially controlled in exercise.

- [FACT] All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode.
- [FACT] Appoints the Prime Minister and, on PM advice, other ministers.
- [FACT] Appoints the Attorney General, CAG, Governors, Finance Commission, UPSC members, Election Commissioners under applicable constitutional/statutory processes, and Supreme Court/High Court judges.
- [FACT] Can require the Prime Minister to communicate Council decisions and information and to place before the Council a minister's decision not considered by it (Article 78).
- [FACT] Directly administers Union Territories through administrators to the extent provided by the Constitution.
- [FACT] Appoints commissions for specified constitutional purposes, including Finance Commission and certain official-language/backward-class inquiries where applicable.
- [LIMIT] Appointment in the President's name does not mean unfettered personal selection; constitutional provisions, statutes, judicial doctrine and ministerial advice control different offices.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - EXECUTIVE POWERS

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Executive powers			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Executive powers · Article 77 · Article 78 · Executive · All Union · President's	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT The operative mechanism matters because All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Its principal consequence is that All Union executive action is expressed in the President's name; authenticated orders receive Article 77 protection as to mode.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: the decisive contrast is between All Union executive action is expressed in the President's...
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Appointment in the President's name does not mean unfettered personal selection; constitutional provisions, statutes, judicial doctrine and ministerial advice control different offices.			

SESSION 11 - LEGISLATIVE POWERS AND PARLIAMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Legislative powers and Parliament denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Summons and prorogues either House and dissolves Lok Sabha on advice/convention.

Technical definition: The decisive contrast is between The former power to nominate two Anglo-Indian members to Lok Sabha ceased through the 104th Amendment framework and Causes the Budget and constitutional reports to be laid before Parliament.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The President's legislative functions facilitate Parliament's operation, but recommendation, nomination, summoning and assent are constitutional roles generally exercised within the parliamentary advice framework.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Legislative powers
- Parliament
- Article 108
- Legislative powers and Parliament
- Legislative
- Summons

How to use them: Frame the answer through Legislative powers; define Parliament, connect Article 108 with Legislative powers and Parliament to explain the mechanism, and use Legislative for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Legislative powers and Parliament denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] Summons and prorogues either House and dissolves Lok Sabha on advice/convention. Legislative powers and Parliament operates through [FACT] Addresses Parliament after each general election to Lok Sabha and at the first session each year, connected with [FACT] May address either/both Houses and send messages. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] Summons a joint sitting of both Houses for an ordinary legislative deadlock under Article 108. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] Nominates 12 Rajya Sabha members with special knowledge/practical experience in literature, science, art and social service. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] The former power to nominate two Anglo-Indian members to Lok Sabha ceased through the 104th Amendment framework and [FACT] Causes the Budget and constitutional reports to be laid before Parliament. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] Prior presidential recommendation is constitutionally required for specified financial and other bills.

- [FACT] Summons and prorogues either House and dissolves Lok Sabha on advice/convention.
- [FACT] Addresses Parliament after each general election to Lok Sabha and at the first session each year.
- [FACT] May address either/both Houses and send messages.
- [FACT] Summons a joint sitting of both Houses for an ordinary legislative deadlock under Article 108.
- [FACT] Nominates 12 Rajya Sabha members with special knowledge/practical experience in literature, science, art and social service.
- [FACT] The former power to nominate two Anglo-Indian members to Lok Sabha ceased through the 104th Amendment framework.
- [FACT] Causes the Budget and constitutional reports to be laid before Parliament.
- [FACT] Prior presidential recommendation is constitutionally required for specified financial and other bills.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LEGISLATIVE POWERS AND PARLIAMENT

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Legislative powers and Parliament			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Legislative powers · Parliament · Article 108 · Legislative powers and Parliament · Legislative · Summons	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT The decisive contrast is between The former power to nominate two Anglo-Indian members to Lok Sabha ceased through the 104th Amendment framework and Causes the Budget and constitutional reports to be laid before Parliament.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Its principal consequence is that Nominates 12 Rajya Sabha members with special knowledge/practical experience in literature, science, art and social service.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: the exam-safe limitation is that Prior presidential recommendation is constitutionally required for specified financial...
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The President's legislative functions facilitate Parliament's operation, but recommendation, nomination, summoning and assent are constitutional roles generally exercised within the parliamentary advice framework.			

SESSION 12 - VETO UNDER ARTICLE 111 AND RESERVED STATE BILLS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Veto under Article 111 and reserved State bills denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Parliamentary bills.

Technical definition: Article 201 is not a personal federal veto exercised outside Article 74 advice.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The 20 November 2025 Article 143 opinion held that courts cannot create rigid timelines or deemed assent, but glaring, prolonged and unexplained inaction can attract limited directions to decide.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Veto under Article 111
- reserved State bills
- Ordinary Bill
- Assent; withhold assent; return once for reconsideration
- Money Bill
- Assent or withhold; cannot return

How to use them: Frame the answer through Veto under Article 111; define reserved State bills, connect Ordinary Bill with Assent; withhold assent; return once for reconsideration to explain the mechanism, and use Money Bill for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Veto under Article 111 and reserved State bills denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Parliamentary bills. Veto under Article 111 and reserved State bills operates through Ordinary Bill Assent; withhold assent; return once for reconsideration, connected with Money Bill Assent or withhold; cannot return. The operative mechanism matters because constitution Amendment Bill Must assent after the 24th Amendment. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] If Parliament re-passes a returned ordinary bill, with or without amendments, the President cannot withhold assent. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] Re-passage needs only the ordinary majority applicable to the bill, not a special veto-override majority and [FACT] The Constitution gives no fixed deadline for Article 111 assent. This permits a pocket veto. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] Zail Singh's handling of the Indian Post Office (Amendment) Bill, 1986 is the standard pocket-veto illustration.

Presidential veto matrix

Absolute Withhold assent and bill ends	Suspensive Return ordinary bill once	Pocket No fixed assent deadline
Money Bill Cannot be returned	Amendment Bill Assent is obligatory	Reserved State Bill State repassage does not override President

Ordinary, Money, Amendment and reserved State bills produce different presidential options.

Parliamentary bills

Bill	Options
Ordinary Bill	Assent; withhold assent; return once for reconsideration
Money Bill	Assent or withhold; cannot return
Constitution Amendment Bill	Must assent after the 24th Amendment

- [FACT] If Parliament re-passes a returned ordinary bill, with or without amendments, the President cannot withhold assent.
- [FACT] Re-passage needs only the ordinary majority applicable to the bill, not a special veto-override majority.
- [FACT] The Constitution gives no fixed deadline for Article 111 assent. This permits a pocket veto.
- [FACT] Zail Singh's handling of the Indian Post Office (Amendment) Bill, 1986 is the standard pocket-veto illustration.
- [ANALYSIS] Absolute veto is most plausible for private-member bills or a government bill after the ministry has resigned; in normal government legislation ministerial advice dominates.

State bills reserved under Article 201

- [FACT] The President may assent, withhold assent, or direct the Governor to return a non-Money Bill.
- [FACT] If the State legislature re-passes and re-presents it, the President is not textually compelled to assent; this differs from Article 111.
- [CURRENT] The 20 November 2025 Article 143 opinion held that courts cannot create rigid timelines or deemed assent, but glaring, prolonged and unexplained inaction can attract limited directions to decide.
- [LIMIT] Article 201 is not a personal federal veto exercised outside Article 74 advice.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - VETO UNDER ARTICLE 111 AND RESERVED STATE BILLS

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Veto under Article 111 and reserved State bills			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Veto under Article 111 · reserved State bills · Ordinary Bill · Assent; withhold assent; return once for reconsideration · Money Bill · Assent or withhold; cannot return	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT The operative mechanism matters because constitution Amendment Bill Must assent after the 24th Amendment.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The decisive contrast is between Re-passage needs only the ordinary majority applicable to the bill, not a special veto-override majority and The Constitution gives no fixed deadline for Article 111 assent.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Article 201 is not a personal federal veto exercised outside Article 74 advice.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The 20 November 2025 Article 143 opinion held that courts cannot create rigid timelines or deemed assent, but glaring, prolonged and unexplained inaction can attract limited directions to decide.			

SESSION 13 - ORDINANCE-MAKING POWER UNDER ARTICLE 123

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Ordinance-making power under Article 123 denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around An ordinance may be promulgated except when both Houses are in session .

Technical definition: The ordinance power is legitimate for urgency, not for avoiding an inconvenient House.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Article 123 ordinances carry Act-like force within Parliament's competence, but remain temporary and subject to legislative and constitutional control.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Ordinance-making power under Article 123
- both Houses are in session
- Article 123
- Article 20
- Ordinance-making

- Article

How to use them: Frame the answer through Ordinance-making power under Article 123; define both Houses are in session, connect Article 123 with Article 20 to explain the mechanism, and use Ordinance-making for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Ordinance-making power under Article 123 denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] An ordinance may be promulgated except when both Houses are in session . It is enough that one House is not sitting. Ordinance-making power under Article 123 operates through [FACT] It may amend or repeal a Central Act and may operate retrospectively, subject especially to Article 20(1), connected with [FACT] It cannot abridge Fundamental Rights and cannot amend the Constitution. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] The President may withdraw it at any time on advice. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] R. C. Cooper (1970): ordinance satisfaction is not completely beyond review. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] D. C. Wadhwa (1987): routine re-promulgation without legislative consideration is a fraud on the Constitution and [ANALYSIS] The ordinance power is legitimate for urgency, not for avoiding an inconvenient House. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] An ordinance may be promulgated except when both Houses are in session . It is enough that one House is not sitting.

Article 123 ordinance lifecycle



An ordinance is temporary legislation, not an alternative permanent lawmaking channel.

- [FACT] An ordinance may be promulgated except when **both Houses are in session**. It is enough that one House is not sitting.
- [FACT] The President must be satisfied that circumstances require immediate action; this satisfaction is ministerially formed and judicially reviewable on limited grounds.
- [FACT] It has the same force and effect as an Act of Parliament but only within Parliament's legislative competence and constitutional limits.
- [FACT] It may amend or repeal a Central Act and may operate retrospectively, subject especially to Article 20(1).
- [FACT] It cannot abridge Fundamental Rights and cannot amend the Constitution.
- [FACT] It must be laid before both Houses and ceases six weeks after the later date of their reassembly, unless disapproved earlier by both Houses.
- [FACT] The President may withdraw it at any time on advice.
- [ANALYSIS] Its maximum practical life is approximately six months plus six weeks because six months is the maximum constitutional gap between parliamentary sessions.

Judicial controls

- [FACT] *R. C. Cooper* (1970): ordinance satisfaction is not completely beyond review.
- [FACT] *D. C. Wadhwa* (1987): routine re-promulgation without legislative consideration is a fraud on the Constitution.
- [FACT] *Krishna Kumar Singh* (2017, seven judges, 5:2): laying is mandatory; re-promulgation subverts legislative supremacy; enduring rights do not automatically survive every lapsed ordinance.
- [ANALYSIS] The ordinance power is legitimate for urgency, not for avoiding an inconvenient House.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ORDINANCE-MAKING POWER UNDER ARTICLE 123

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | Ordinance-making power under Article 123

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

Ordinance-making power under Article 123 · both Houses are in session · Article 123 · Article 20 · Ordinance-making · Article

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

It must be laid before both Houses and ceases six weeks after the later date of their reassembly, unless disapproved earlier by both Houses.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Wadhwa (1987): routine re-promulgation without legislative consideration is a fraud on the Constitution and The ordinance power is legitimate for urgency, not for avoiding an inconvenient House.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

The ordinance power is legitimate for urgency, not for avoiding an inconvenient House.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 123 ordinances carry Act-like force within Parliament's competence, but remain temporary and subject to legislative and constitutional control.

SESSION 14 - FINANCIAL, JUDICIAL, DIPLOMATIC, MILITARY AND EMERGENCY POWERS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Financial, judicial, diplomatic, military and emergency powers denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around A Money Bill needs prior presidential recommendation.

Technical definition: Financial, judicial, diplomatic, military and emergency powers operates through No demand for a grant can be made except on presidential recommendation, connected with The Annual Financial Statement is caused to be laid before Parliament.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

International treaties and agreements are formally concluded in the President's name but remain governed by the constitutional distribution of executive/legislative power.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Financial
- judicial
- diplomatic
- military
- emergency powers
- Article 72

How to use them: Frame the answer through Financial; define judicial, connect diplomatic with military to explain the mechanism, and use emergency powers for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Financial, judicial, diplomatic, military and emergency powers denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] A Money Bill needs prior presidential recommendation. Financial, judicial, diplomatic, military and emergency powers operates through [FACT] No demand for a grant can be made except on presidential recommendation, connected with [FACT] The Annual Financial Statement is caused to be laid before Parliament. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] Appoints Supreme Court and High Court judges under the constitutional appointments framework. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] Exercises clemency under Article 72. The decisive contrast is between Diplomatic, military and emergency and [FACT] The President is Supreme Commander of the defence forces; operational authority belongs to elected government under law. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] A Money Bill needs prior presidential recommendation.

Financial

- [FACT] A Money Bill needs prior presidential recommendation.
- [FACT] No demand for a grant can be made except on presidential recommendation.
- [FACT] The Annual Financial Statement is caused to be laid before Parliament.
- [FACT] The President constitutes a Finance Commission every five years or earlier and can authorise advances from the Contingency Fund pending parliamentary approval.

Judicial

- [FACT] Appoints Supreme Court and High Court judges under the constitutional appointments framework.
- [FACT] May seek the Supreme Court's advisory opinion under Article 143. The opinion is not binding in the same way as an adjudicated decree.
- [FACT] Exercises clemency under Article 72.

Diplomatic, military and emergency

- [FACT] International treaties and agreements are formally concluded in the President's name but remain governed by the constitutional distribution of executive/legislative power.
- [FACT] The President is Supreme Commander of the defence forces; operational authority belongs to elected government under law.
- [FACT] National, State and Financial Emergency proclamations are presidential acts under Articles 352, 356 and 360, controlled by advice, parliamentary approval and judicial review.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FINANCIAL, JUDICIAL, DIPLOMATIC, MILITARY AND EMERGENCY POWERS

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Financial, judicial, diplomatic, military and emergency powers			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Financial · judicial · diplomatic · military · emergency powers · Article 72	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Financial, judicial, diplomatic, military and emergency powers operates through No demand for a grant can be made except on presidential recommendation, connected with The Annual Financial Statement is caused to be laid before Parliament.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The decisive contrast is between Diplomatic, military and emergency and The President is Supreme Commander of the defence forces; operational authority belongs to elected government under law.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: national, State and Financial Emergency proclamations are presidential acts under Articles 352, 356 and...
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: International treaties and agreements are formally concluded in the President's name but remain governed by the constitutional distribution of executive/legislative power.			

SESSION 15 - PARDONING POWER UNDER ARTICLE 72

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Pardoning power under Article 72 denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Cases where punishment/sentence is by court-martial.

Technical definition: Pardoning power under Article 72 operates through Offences against laws concerning matters to which Union executive power extends, connected with Every case where the sentence is death.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Unexplained mercy-petition delay can have constitutional consequences in death-sentence cases, but no automatic numerical rule replaces case-sensitive review.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

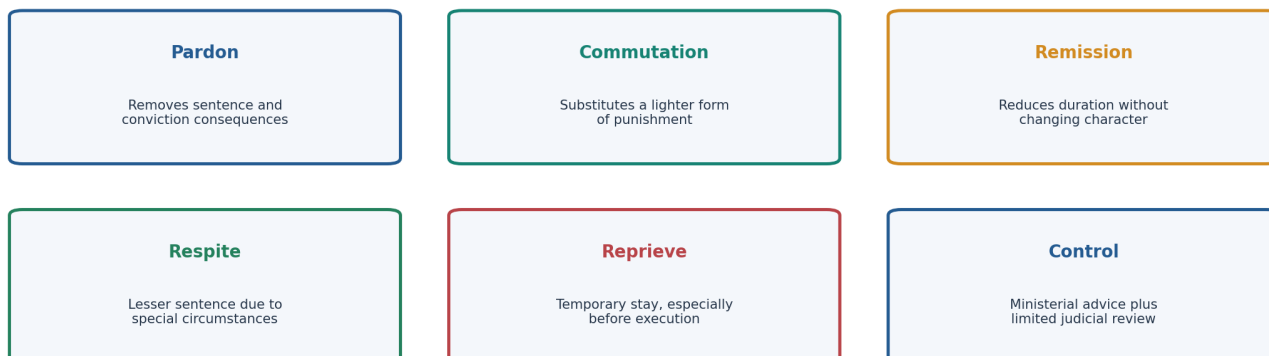
- Pardoning power under Article 72
- Pardon
- Commutation
- Remission
- Respite
- Reprieve

How to use them: Frame the answer through Pardoning power under Article 72; define Pardon, connect Commutation with Remission to explain the mechanism, and use Respite for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Pardoning power under Article 72 denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] Cases where punishment/sentence is by court-martial. Pardoning power under Article 72 operates through [FACT] Offences against laws concerning matters to which Union executive power extends, connected with [FACT] Every case where the sentence is death. The operative mechanism matters because pardon Removes punishment and ordinarily the disqualifying consequences of conviction. Its principal consequence is that commutation Replaces one

form of punishment with a lighter form. The decisive contrast is between Remission Reduces the period without changing the character of punishment and Respite Awards a lesser sentence because of a special fact such as pregnancy/disability. The exam-safe limitation is that reprieve Temporarily stays execution to permit consideration of relief.

Article 72 clemency toolkit



Article 72 contains five distinct forms of clemency and remains controlled by advice and limited review.

Jurisdiction

- [FACT] Cases where punishment/sentence is by court-martial.
- [FACT] Offences against laws concerning matters to which Union executive power extends.
- [FACT] Every case where the sentence is death.

Five forms

Form	Meaning
Pardon	Removes punishment and ordinarily the disqualifying consequences of conviction
Commutation	Replaces one form of punishment with a lighter form
Remission	Reduces the period without changing the character of punishment
Respite	Awards a lesser sentence because of a special fact such as pregnancy/disability
Reprieve	Temporarily stays execution to permit consideration of relief

Advice, merits and review

- [FACT] *Maru Ram* (1980): clemency is exercised on binding ministerial advice.
- [FACT] *Kehar Singh* (1989): the executive may examine the merits afresh; the President is not an appellate court and need not give a judicial-style hearing.
- [FACT] *Epuru Sudhakar* (2006): limited review lies for mala fides, arbitrariness, non-application of mind and relevant/irrelevant-material defects.
- [FACT] Unexplained mercy-petition delay can have constitutional consequences in death-sentence cases, but no automatic numerical rule replaces case-sensitive review.

President versus Governor

Point	President, Article 72	Governor, Article 161
Court-martial	Can grant all forms	No power
Death sentence	Can pardon and grant lesser forms	Cannot pardon, but may suspend/remit/commute
Ordinary offences	Union executive field	State executive field
Advice	Union Council	State Council

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PARDONING POWER UNDER ARTICLE 72

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Pardoning power under Article 72			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Pardoning power under Article 72 · Pardon · Commutation · Remission · Respite · Reprieve	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Pardoning power under Article 72 operates through Offences against laws concerning matters to which Union executive power extends, connected with Every case where the sentence is death.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The decisive contrast is between Remission Reduces the period without changing the character of punishment and Respite Awards a lesser sentence because of a special fact such as pregnancy/disability.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: its principal consequence is that commutation Replaces one form of punishment with a lighter...
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Unexplained mercy-petition delay can have constitutional consequences in death-sentence cases, but no automatic numerical rule replaces case-sensitive review.			

SESSION 16 - VICE-PRESIDENT: ELECTION AND QUALIFICATIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Vice-President: election and qualifications denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around The electoral college consists of all members of both Houses of Parliament , elected and nominated.

Technical definition: Election disputes are decided finally by the Supreme Court under Article 71.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Vice-President is elected by all members of both Houses through PR-STV, excluding State legislators and thereby reflecting the office's primarily Union parliamentary character.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Vice-President
- election
- qualifications
- all members of both Houses of Parliament
- Article 71
- Vice-President: election and qualifications

How to use them: Frame the answer through Vice-President; define election, connect qualifications with all members of both Houses of Parliament to explain the mechanism, and use Article 71 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Vice-President: election and qualifications denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] The electoral college consists of all members of both Houses of Parliament , elected and nominated. Vice-President: election and qualifications operates through [FACT] No State or UT legislator votes, connected with [FACT] Election uses PR-STV and secret ballot; all votes have equal value. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] Qualifications: citizen, 35 years, qualified for election to Rajya Sabha, and no disqualifying office of profit. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] A candidate needs 20 proposers and 20 seconders and the statutory deposit. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] The President, or a person appointed by the President, administers the oath and [FACT] Election disputes are decided finally by the Supreme Court under Article 71. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] The electoral college consists of all members of both Houses of Parliament , elected and nominated.

Vice-Presidential design



The Vice-President has a Parliament-only electoral college and a distinct casual-vacancy rule.

- [FACT] The electoral college consists of **all members of both Houses of Parliament**, elected and nominated.
- [FACT] No State or UT legislator votes.
- [FACT] Election uses PR-STV and secret ballot; all votes have equal value.
- [FACT] Qualifications: citizen, 35 years, qualified for election to Rajya Sabha, and no disqualifying office of profit.
- [FACT] A candidate needs 20 proposers and 20 seconders and the statutory deposit.
- [FACT] The President, or a person appointed by the President, administers the oath.
- [FACT] Election disputes are decided finally by the Supreme Court under Article 71.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - VICE-PRESIDENT: ELECTION AND QUALIFICATIONS

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Vice-President: election and qualifications			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Vice-President · election · qualifications · all members of both Houses of Parliament · Article 71 · Vice-President: election and qualifications	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Vice-President: election and qualifications operates through No State or UT legislator votes, connected with Election uses PR-STV and secret ballot; all votes have equal value.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The decisive contrast is between The President, or a person appointed by the President, administers the oath and Election disputes are decided finally by the Supreme Court under Article 71.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: its principal consequence is that A candidate needs 20 proposers and 20 seconders and...
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Vice-President is elected by all members of both Houses through PR-STV, excluding State legislators and thereby reflecting the office's primarily Union parliamentary character.			

SESSION 17 - VICE-PRESIDENTIAL TERM, RESIGNATION, REMOVAL AND VACANCY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Vice-Presidential term, resignation, removal and vacancy denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Term: five years; the Vice-President continues until the successor enters office.

Technical definition: Vice-Presidential term, resignation, removal and vacancy operates through Resignation is addressed to the President, connected with Only Rajya Sabha can initiate; at least 14 days' notice is required; no constitutional ground is stated.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Lok Sabha agreement is by its ordinary voting majority unless a contrary special rule exists.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Vice-Presidential term
- resignation
- removal

- vacancy
- all the then members
- as soon as possible

How to use them: Frame the answer through Vice-Presidential term; define resignation, connect removal with vacancy to explain the mechanism, and use all the then members for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Vice-Presidential term, resignation, removal and vacancy denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] Term: five years; the Vice-President continues until the successor enters office.

Vice-Presidential term, resignation, removal and vacancy operates through [FACT] Resignation is addressed to the President, connected with [FACT] Only Rajya Sabha can initiate; at least 14 days' notice is required; no constitutional ground is stated. The operative mechanism matters because [LIMIT] This is removal, not impeachment. Lok Sabha agreement is by its ordinary voting majority unless a contrary special rule exists. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] Election for a vacancy expected on expiry must be completed before expiry. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] A casual vacancy must be filled as soon as possible ; unlike the President, Article 68 specifies no six-month outer deadline and [FACT] The successor in a casual vacancy receives a fresh five-year term. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] Term: five years; the Vice-President continues until the successor enters office.

- [FACT] Term: five years; the Vice-President continues until the successor enters office.
- [FACT] Resignation is addressed to the President.
- [FACT] Removal is by a resolution of Rajya Sabha passed by a majority of **all the then members** (effective majority) and agreed to by Lok Sabha.
- [FACT] Only Rajya Sabha can initiate; at least 14 days' notice is required; no constitutional ground is stated.
- [LIMIT] This is removal, not impeachment. Lok Sabha agreement is by its ordinary voting majority unless a contrary special rule exists.
- [FACT] Election for a vacancy expected on expiry must be completed before expiry.
- [FACT] A casual vacancy must be filled **as soon as possible**; unlike the President, Article 68 specifies no six-month outer deadline.
- [FACT] The successor in a casual vacancy receives a fresh five-year term.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - VICE-PRESIDENTIAL TERM, RESIGNATION, REMOVAL AND VACANCY

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Vice-Presidential term, resignation, removal and vacancy			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Vice-Presidential term · resignation · removal · vacancy · all the then members · as soon as possible	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Vice-Presidential term, resignation, removal and vacancy operates through Resignation is addressed to the President, connected with Only Rajya Sabha can initiate; at least 14 days' notice is required; no constitutional ground is stated.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The decisive contrast is between A casual vacancy must be filled as soon as possible ; unlike the President, Article 68 specifies no six-month outer deadline and The successor in a casual vacancy receives a fresh five-year term.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: a casual vacancy must be filled as soon as possible.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Lok Sabha agreement is by its ordinary voting majority unless a contrary special rule exists.			

SESSION 18 - THE VICE-PRESIDENT AS RAJYA SABHA CHAIRMAN

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha.

Technical definition: The Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman operates through The Chairman is not a Rajya Sabha member and has no first-instance vote; Article 100 gives a casting vote when votes are equal, connected with Does not certify Money Bills; that constitutional function belongs to the Lok Sabha Speaker.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Vice-President may speak/take part but cannot vote even though normally possessing a casting vote.

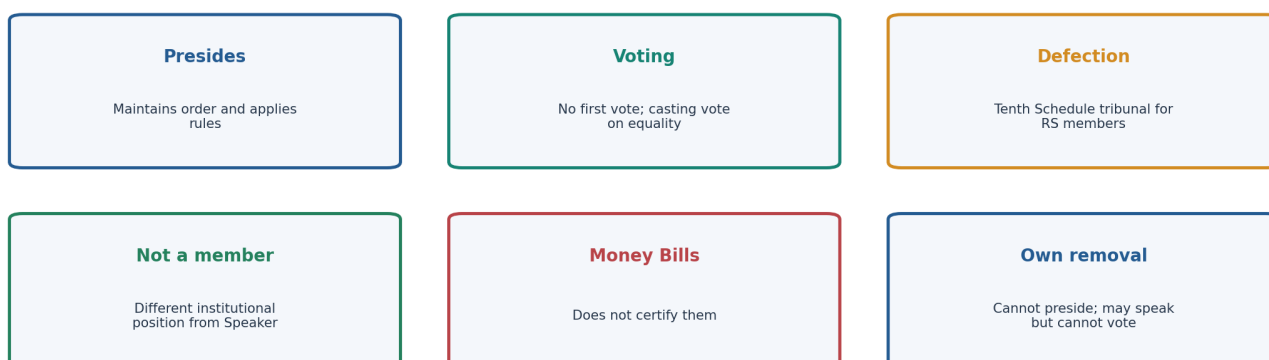
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman
- Article 64
- Article 100
- Article 92
- The Vice-President
- Rajya Sabha Chairman

How to use them: Frame the answer through The Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman; define Article 64, connect Article 100 with Article 92 to explain the mechanism, and use The Vice-President for the decisive comparison or qualification.

The Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha. The Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman operates through [FACT] The Chairman is not a Rajya Sabha member and has no first-instance vote; Article 100 gives a casting vote when votes are equal, connected with [FACT] Does not certify Money Bills; that constitutional function belongs to the Lok Sabha Speaker. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha and [FACT] Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha.

Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman



The Chair combines procedural authority, a casting vote and a reviewable anti-defection role.

- [FACT] Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha.
- [FACT] The Chairman is not a Rajya Sabha member and has no first-instance vote; Article 100 gives a casting vote when votes are equal.
- [FACT] Presides, maintains order, interprets rules, decides points of order/admissibility and coordinates committee references under House rules.
- [FACT] Decides Tenth Schedule disqualification questions for Rajya Sabha members; *Kihoto Hollohan* makes the decision judicially reviewable.
- [FACT] Does not certify Money Bills; that constitutional function belongs to the Lok Sabha Speaker.
- [FACT] During consideration of the Vice-President's own removal resolution, Article 92 bars him/her from presiding. The Vice-President may speak/take part but cannot vote even though normally possessing a casting vote.
- [ANALYSIS] Because Rajya Sabha articulates State interests and revising scrutiny, the office's practical authority depends heavily on demonstrable neutrality.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE VICE-PRESIDENT AS RAJYA SABHA CHAIRMAN

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | The Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

The Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman · Article 64 · Article 100 · Article 92 · The Vice-President · Rajya Sabha Chairman

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The Vice-President as Rajya Sabha Chairman operates through The Chairman is not a Rajya Sabha member and has no first-instance vote; Article 100 gives a casting vote when votes are equal, connected with Does not certify Money Bills; that constitutional function belongs to the Lok Sabha Speaker.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Its principal consequence is that Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not miss this limiting distinction: the decisive contrast is between Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Vice-President may speak/take part but cannot vote even though normally possessing a casting vote.

SESSION 19 - ACTING AS PRESIDENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Acting as President denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary.

Technical definition: The Vice-President acts as President when the presidential office falls vacant and discharges functions when the President is unable because of absence, illness or another cause.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Vice-President acts as President when the presidential office falls vacant and discharges functions when the President is unable because of absence, illness or another cause.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Acting as President
- presidential
- Acting
- President
- Vice-President
- Chairman's

How to use them: Frame the answer through Acting as President; define presidential, connect Acting with President to explain the mechanism, and use Vice-President for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Acting as President denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [FACT] The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary. Acting as President operates through [LIMIT] The six-month rule attaches to filling the presidential vacancy, not to filling a Vice-Presidential vacancy, connected with [FACT] The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary. The operative mechanism matters because [FACT] The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary. Its principal consequence is that [FACT] The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary. The decisive contrast is between [FACT] The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary and [FACT] The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary. The exam-safe limitation is that [FACT] The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary.

- [FACT] The Vice-President acts as President when the presidential office falls vacant and discharges functions when the President is unable because of absence, illness or another cause.
- [FACT] During that period, the Vice-President does not perform Rajya Sabha Chairman duties; the Deputy Chairman performs the presiding function.

- [FACT] The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary.
- [FACT] The acting arrangement after a presidential casual vacancy ends when the new President enters office; the presidential election must occur within six months.
- [LIMIT] The six-month rule attaches to filling the **presidential** vacancy, not to filling a Vice-Presidential vacancy.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ACTING AS PRESIDENT

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Acting as President			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Acting as President · presidential · Acting · President · Vice-President · Chairman's	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT The Vice-President acts as President when the presidential office falls vacant and discharges functions when the President is unable because of absence, illness or another cause.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Its principal consequence is that The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE The decisive contrast is between The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary and The acting Vice-President receives presidential emoluments/privileges for the period rather than Chairman's salary.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Vice-President acts as President when the presidential office falls vacant and discharges functions when the President is unable because of absence, illness or another cause.			

SESSION 20 - CURRENT CONSTITUTIONAL-OFFICE CONTROL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Current constitutional-office control denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25 July 2022.

Technical definition: Current constitutional-office control operates through [CURRENT] Jagdeep Dhankhar's resignation in July 2025 created a Vice-Presidential casual vacancy, connected with [CURRENT] C.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A Vice-Presidential casual vacancy requires prompt election under Article 68 but carries no six-month textual deadline, and the elected successor receives a full five-year term.

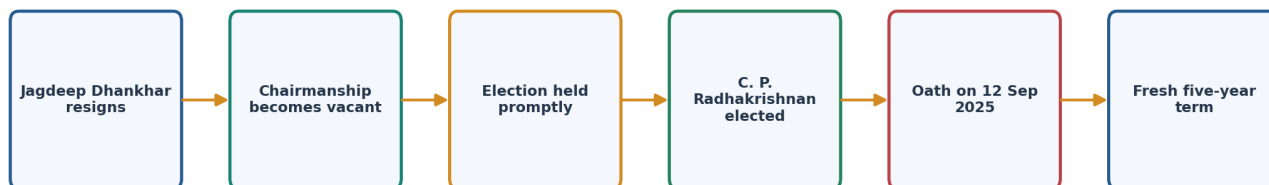
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Current constitutional-office control**
- **Article 68**
- **Droupadi Murmu**
- **President**
- **Jagdeep Dhankhar's**
- **Vice-Presidential**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Current constitutional-office control; define Article 68, connect Droupadi Murmu with President to explain the mechanism, and use Jagdeep Dhankhar's for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Current constitutional-office control denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25 July 2022. Current constitutional-office control operates through [CURRENT] Jagdeep Dhankhar's resignation in July 2025 created a Vice-Presidential casual vacancy, connected with [CURRENT] C. P. Radhakrishnan entered office on 12 September 2025 as the 15th Vice-President. The operative mechanism matters because [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25 July 2022. Its principal consequence is that [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25 July 2022. The decisive contrast is between [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25 July 2022 and [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25 July 2022. The exam-safe limitation is that [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25 July 2022.

The 2025 Vice-Presidential transition



The 2025 transition demonstrates the Vice-President's resignation and fresh-term vacancy rules.

- [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25 July 2022.
- [CURRENT] Jagdeep Dhankhar's resignation in July 2025 created a Vice-Presidential casual vacancy.
- [CURRENT] The Election Commission's official result records C. P. Radhakrishnan elected on 9 September 2025: 452 valid votes to B. Sudershan Reddy's 300, with 15 invalid ballots.
- [CURRENT] C. P. Radhakrishnan entered office on 12 September 2025 as the 15th Vice-President.
- [ANALYSIS] This is the cleanest current example for Article 68: prompt election, no six-month textual deadline, and a fresh five-year term.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CURRENT CONSTITUTIONAL-OFFICE CONTROL

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Current constitutional-office control			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Current constitutional-office control · Article 68 · Droupadi Murmu · President · Jagdeep Dhankhar's · Vice-Presidential	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Current constitutional-office control operates through [CURRENT] Jagdeep Dhankhar's resignation in July 2025 created a Vice-Presidential casual vacancy, connected with [CURRENT] C.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Its principal consequence is that [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25 July 2022.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: the decisive contrast is between [CURRENT] Droupadi Murmu became the 15th President on 25...
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A Vice-Presidential casual vacancy requires prompt election under Article 68 but carries no six-month textual deadline, and the elected successor receives a full five-year term.			

SESSION 21 - MASTER COMPARISON AND TRAP FIREWALL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Master comparison and trap firewall denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Test President Vice-President.

Technical definition: Technically, Master comparison and trap firewall is analysed by relating Master comparison to trap firewall, then testing the relationship through Electoral college and Elected MPs + elected State/Delhi/Puducherry MLAs.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

For a Governor-reserved State Bill, Article 201 permits assent, withholding or direction to return a non-Money Bill; unlike Article 111, State re-passage does not expressly bind the President.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Master comparison
- trap firewall
- Electoral college
- Elected MPs + elected State/Delhi/Puducherry MLAs

- **Elected + nominated MPs only**
- **Vote value**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Master comparison; define trap firewall, connect Electoral college with Elected MPs + elected State/Delhi/Puducherry MLAs to explain the mechanism, and use Elected + nominated MPs only for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Master comparison and trap firewall denotes the constitutional rules and institutional links organised around Test President Vice-President. Master comparison and trap firewall operates through Electoral college Elected MPs + elected State/Delhi/Puducherry MLAs Elected + nominated MPs only, connected with Vote value Weighted Equal. The operative mechanism matters because qualification for House Lok Sabha Rajya Sabha. Its principal consequence is that oath by CJI/senior-most available SC judge President/person appointed. The decisive contrast is between Resignation to Vice-President President and Removal Either House starts; 2/3 total in both RS starts; effective majority + LS agreement. The exam-safe limitation is that ground Violation of Constitution None stated.

Test	President	Vice-President
Electoral college	Elected MPs + elected State/Delhi/Puducherry MLAs	Elected + nominated MPs only
Vote value	Weighted	Equal
Qualification for House	Lok Sabha	Rajya Sabha
Oath by	CJI/senior-most available SC judge	President/person appointed
Resignation to	Vice-President	President
Removal	Either House starts; 2/3 total in both	RS starts; effective majority + LS agreement
Ground	Violation of Constitution	None stated
Casual-vacancy election	Within six months	As soon as possible
Regular function	Head of State on advice	Rajya Sabha Chairman

Trap firewall

- Nominated MPs do not elect the President but do elect the Vice-President and may impeach the President.
- MLAs elect the President but neither elect the Vice-President nor impeach the President.
- MLCs participate in neither election.
- President: qualified for Lok Sabha; Vice-President: qualified for Rajya Sabha.
- Presidential ordinary bill can be returned once; Money Bill cannot; amendment bill must receive assent.
- Article 123 is available when one or both Houses are not in session, not only when both are adjourned.
- Governor cannot pardon a death sentence but can suspend, remit or commute it.
- Article 71 preserves acts done before an election is declared void.
- No fixed Article 111 assent deadline exists.
- VP removal is not impeachment and needs no stated ground.
- VP casual vacancy has no six-month rule; presidential casual vacancy does.
- VP acting as President does not simultaneously chair Rajya Sabha.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - MASTER COMPARISON AND TRAP FIREWALL

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW Master comparison and trap firewall			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Master comparison · trap firewall · Electoral college · Elected MPs + elected State/Delhi/Puducherry MLAs · Elected + nominated MPs only · Vote value	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Its principal consequence is that oath by CJI/senior-most available SC judge President/person appointed.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The decisive contrast is between Resignation to Vice-President President and Removal Either House starts; 2/3 total in both RS starts; effective majority + LS agreement.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Nominated MPs do not elect the President but do elect the Vice-President and may impeach the President.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Original MCQ loop

OM1. Electoral college

Who participates in electing the President?

- A. Elected MPs plus elected State/Delhi/Puducherry MLAs B. Elected MPs and all State legislators C. All MPs and all MLAs D. Only elected MPs

Answer: A.

Article 54 excludes nominated members and all MLAs.

OM2. Vice-Presidential college

Which group elects the Vice-President?

- A. Elected MPs only B. All members of both Houses of Parliament C. Elected MPs plus MLAs D. Rajya Sabha alone

Answer: B.

Nominated MPs participate; no MLA does.

OM3. MLA vote value

The value principally depends on:

- A. Current population only B. Area and population C. 1971 population relative to elected Assembly seats D. Assembly strength only

Answer: C.

The constitutional freeze preserves the 1971 basis until relevant post-2026 census figures are published.

OM4. MP vote value

Which is correct?

- A. Lok Sabha MPs have higher value B. Value varies by State C. Rajya Sabha MPs have higher value D. Every elected MP has the same value

Answer: D.

The aggregate MLA value is divided across elected MPs of both Houses.

OM5. President qualification

The candidate must be qualified for election to:

- A. Lok Sabha B. Either House C. A State Assembly only D. Rajya Sabha

Answer: A.

The Vice-President uses the Rajya Sabha qualification.

OM6. President oath

It is ordinarily administered by the:

- A. Prime Minister B. Chief Justice of India C. Vice-President D. Lok Sabha Speaker

Answer: B.

The senior-most available Supreme Court judge acts in the CJI's absence.

OM7. Re-election

The Constitution permits the President to be re-elected:

- A. Never B. Once only C. Any number of times D. Twice only

Answer: C.

Unlike the US, India sets no numerical limit.

OM8. Casual presidential vacancy

The election must be held within:

A. Three months B. One year C. One month D. Six months

Answer: D.

The successor receives a fresh five-year term.

OM9. Impeachment initiator

A charge may be initiated by:

A. Either House of Parliament B. Rajya Sabha only C. Lok Sabha only D. The electoral college

Answer: A.

Both Houses have symmetrical initiation capacity.

OM10. Impeachment majority

Each decisive House resolution needs:

A. Simple majority B. Two-thirds of total membership C. Special majority plus State ratification D. Effective majority

Answer: B.

This is stricter than two-thirds present and voting.

OM11. Nominated MPs

Which statement is correct?

A. They do neither B. They elect but cannot impeach C. They may impeach but do not elect the President D. They elect and impeach

Answer: C.

Election and impeachment bodies differ.

OM12. Advice

After the President returns advice once and the Council reiterates it:

A. The Supreme Court decides B. Parliament votes C. The President may keep returning it D. The President must accept it

Answer: D.

The 44th Amendment creates one reconsideration, not a veto.

OM13. Hung Lok Sabha

The sound presidential test for appointing a PM is:

A. Likely ability to secure House confidence B. Rajya Sabha strength C. Largest party in every circumstance D. Personal ideological closeness

Answer: A.

Floor confidence controls the discretion.

OM14. Ordinary Bill

If Parliament re-passes a returned ordinary Bill:

A. A two-thirds override is needed B. The President must assent C. The President may return it again D. A referendum follows

Answer: B.

Article 111 makes the second presentation conclusive.

OM15. Money Bill

The President may not:

- A. Withhold assent B. Act on advice C. Return it for reconsideration D. Assent

Answer: C.

A Money Bill already required presidential recommendation before introduction.

OM16. Amendment Bill

After valid passage, presidential assent is:

- A. Optional B. Returnable once C. Subject to States D. Obligatory

Answer: D.

The 24th Amendment removed veto uncertainty.

OM17. Pocket veto

Its textual basis is:

- A. No fixed Article 111 deadline B. A six-month clause C. Supreme Court permission D. Rajya Sabha approval

Answer: A.

It is inferred from silence, not named as pocket veto.

OM18. Ordinance timing

Article 123 is available when:

- A. Both Houses must be dissolved B. Both Houses are not simultaneously in session C. Lok Sabha alone is dissolved D. A National Emergency exists

Answer: B.

One House not sitting is sufficient.

OM19. Ordinance end

Unless earlier disapproved/withdrawn, it ceases:

- A. Immediately on reassembly B. After one year C. Six weeks after later reassembly date D. After six months

Answer: C.

Different reassembly dates use the later date.

OM20. Re-promulgation

D.C. Wadhwa characterises routine re-promulgation as:

- A. Pocket veto B. Collective responsibility C. Basic Structure D. Fraud on the Constitution

Answer: D.

The executive cannot maintain ordinance rule without legislative consideration.

OM21. Article 72

Which falls uniquely within presidential clemency?

- A. Court-martial sentence B. Every State-law offence C. Legislative privilege D. Civil decree

Answer: A.

The Governor has no court-martial clemency power.

OM22. Governor and death

A Governor may:

- A. Pardon a death sentence B. Suspend/remit/commute but not pardon death C. Do nothing concerning death sentence D. Review a court-martial

Answer: B.

Article 161 is narrower than Article 72.

OM23. Clemency review

Epuru Sudhakar supports review for:

A. Any disagreement on mercy B. No grounds whatsoever C. Mala fides/non-application of mind D. Incorrect evidence appreciation alone

Answer: C.

Courts review decision-making defects, not sit as clemency appellate bodies.

OM24. VP removal

The resolution starts in:

A. Either House B. Joint sitting C. Lok Sabha D. Rajya Sabha

Answer: D.

Rajya Sabha needs an effective majority; Lok Sabha agrees.

OM25. VP casual vacancy

The Constitution requires election:

A. As soon as possible B. Only at Parliament's next session C. Within one year D. Within six months

Answer: A.

Article 68 has no fixed six-month outer limit.

OM26. Chairman vote

The Rajya Sabha Chairman ordinarily has:

A. A first vote only B. No first vote but a casting vote C. Two votes D. No vote under any circumstance

Answer: B.

During his own removal motion, even the casting vote is unavailable.

OM27. Acting President

While the VP acts as President:

A. Lok Sabha Speaker chairs Rajya Sabha B. He also chairs Rajya Sabha C. Deputy Chairman performs Chairman duties D. Rajya Sabha is suspended

Answer: C.

Article 64 prevents simultaneous discharge of Chair duties.

OM28. Article 143

The Supreme Court's advisory opinion is:

A. A constitutional amendment B. Always a binding decree C. An ordinance D. Advisory, not binding like an adjudicated decree

Answer: D.

The President may seek advice on qualifying questions of law/fact.

Remedial MCQs

R1. College reversal

Which pairing is correct?

- A. President: elected MPs + specified elected MLAs; VP: all MPs B. Both: MPs + MLAs C. Both: elected MPs only D. President: all MPs; VP: elected MPs + MLAs

Answer: A.

Remember: P includes elected provinces; VP is Parliament only.

R2. Removal arithmetic

Vice-President removal in Rajya Sabha requires:

- A. Two-thirds present and voting B. Majority of all then members C. Two-thirds total membership D. Simple majority

Answer: B.

This is the effective majority.

R3. Six-month trap

The explicit six-month casual-vacancy deadline applies to:

- A. Both offices B. Vice-President only C. President only D. Neither

Answer: C.

VP vacancy is filled as soon as possible.

R4. Article 111

Which bill cannot be returned and cannot be vetoed?

- A. Ordinary Bill B. State Bill C. Money Bill D. Constitution Amendment Bill

Answer: D.

Money Bill cannot be returned but assent may theoretically be withheld; amendment assent is obligatory.

R5. Void election

Acts done before the Supreme Court voids a presidential election:

- A. Remain valid B. Automatically vanish C. Need CJI approval D. Need parliamentary ratification

Answer: A.

Article 71 protects continuity.

R6. Ordinance

Which statement is correct?

- A. It needs both Houses dissolved B. It may be retrospective within constitutional limits C. It can amend the Constitution D. It can abridge Fundamental Rights

Answer: B.

Act-like force remains subject to the Constitution.

R7. Death clemency

Which is accurate?

- A. Neither can act B. Only Governor can pardon death C. President can pardon; Governor cannot pardon but can commute D. Both can pardon death

Answer: C.

Separate pardon from lesser clemency forms.

R8. Own removal debate

While the VP's removal is under consideration, the VP:

A. Presides normally B. Cannot participate at all C. Has a casting vote D. May speak but cannot preside or vote

Answer: D.

Article 92 creates the special rule.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Solved UPSC PYQs

PYQ 1 - 2018 Prelims GS-I Q32

Question: With reference to the election of the President of India, consider the following statements:

1. The value of the vote of each MLA varies from State to State.
2. The value of the vote of MPs of the Lok Sabha is more than the value of the vote of MPs of the Rajya Sabha.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 1 only B. 2 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: A.

Solution: Statement 1 is correct because MLA value depends on the State's 1971 population-to-elected-MLA ratio. Statement 2 is false because every elected MP has the same value regardless of House.

PYQ 2 - 2022 GS-II Q4

Question: Discuss the role of the Vice-President of India as the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha. (150 words, 10 marks)

Model answer: Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha; this presiding role, not the rare acting-presidential contingency, is the office's regular constitutional work.

The Chairman maintains order, interprets rules, decides points of order and admissibility, allocates proceedings under House rules and refers matters to committees. Though not a Rajya Sabha member, Article 100 gives a casting vote when votes are equal. Under paragraph 6 of the Tenth Schedule, the Chairman decides defection cases concerning Rajya Sabha members, subject to judicial review after *Kihoto Hollohan*. The Chairman neither votes initially nor certifies Money Bills, unlike the Lok Sabha Speaker's Article 110 function. Under Article 92, while the Vice-President's removal resolution is considered, he/she cannot preside and may speak but not vote.

As Rajya Sabha represents States and revises legislation, neutral rule enforcement is essential. Thus, the Chair's legal powers matter, but perceived impartiality is the foundation of their democratic legitimacy.

PYQ 3 - 2022 GS-II Q14

Question: Critically examine the procedures through which the Presidents of India and France are elected. (250 words, 15 marks)

Model answer: The two procedures reflect different executive designs. India's President is a nominal federal Head of State; France's President is a powerful actor in a semi-presidential system.

India uses an indirect electoral college of elected MPs and elected State, Delhi and Puducherry MLAs. Nominated members and MLCs are excluded. MLA votes are weighted by the 1971 population-to-seat ratio and MP value balances aggregate State and Union votes. PR-STV, a secret ranked ballot and preference transfers produce a majority-supported winner. The method embeds federal parity and avoids creating a direct rival mandate to the responsible Cabinet. Its weakness is democratic remoteness and complexity.

France uses direct universal suffrage. A candidate needs an absolute majority in the first round; otherwise the two leading candidates contest a second round. The method creates a clear nationwide personal mandate appropriate to a politically active President. However, direct presidential and legislative mandates can conflict, producing cohabitation or divided executive leadership.

Therefore, India's election privileges federal mediation and parliamentary logic; France privileges popular authorization and executive leadership. Neither procedure is superior without reference to the office it elects.

PYQ 4 - 2023 Prelims GS-I Q36

Question: Consider the following statements:

1. If the election of the President is declared void by the Supreme Court, all acts done before the decision become invalid.
2. Presidential election can be postponed because some Legislative Assemblies are dissolved and elections are pending.
3. The Constitution prescribes a time limit for presidential assent to a Bill.

How many statements are correct?

A. Only one B. Only two C. All three D. None

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: D.

Solution: All are false. Article 71(2) preserves acts already done; electoral-college vacancies do not invalidate/postpone the election; Article 111 fixes no assent deadline.

PYQ 5 - 2023 Prelims GS-I Q80

Question: Consider the following statements in respect of election to the President of India:

1. Nominated members of Parliament or State Assemblies are included.
2. Higher the number of elective Assembly seats, higher is each MLA's vote value.
3. Each Madhya Pradesh MLA has a higher value than each Kerala MLA.
4. Puducherry MLA value is higher than Arunachal Pradesh because its population-to-elective-seat ratio is higher.

How many statements are correct?

A. Only one B. Only two C. Only three D. All four

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: A.

Solution: Only statement 4 is correct. Nominated members are excluded. Vote value depends on population divided by elected seats, so more seats do not mechanically increase value. Kerala's per-MLA value exceeds Madhya Pradesh's under the frozen data.

PYQ 6 - 2025 Prelims GS-I Q51

Question: With reference to Indian polity, consider the following statements:

1. An Ordinance can amend any Central Act.
2. An Ordinance can abridge a Fundamental Right.
3. An Ordinance can come into effect from a back date.

Which are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

Official Set-A answer: C.

Solution: An ordinance has Act-like force and may amend a Central Act or operate retrospectively within constitutional limits. It is "law" under Article 13 and cannot abridge Fundamental Rights.

PYQ 7 - 2025 Prelims GS-I Q86

Question: Consider the following statements regarding the pardoning power of the President:

1. Its exercise can be subjected to limited judicial review.
2. The President can exercise it without advice of the Central Government.

Which is/are correct?

A. 1 only B. 2 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Official Set-A answer: A.

Solution: *Epuru Sudhakar* permits limited review for defects such as mala fides and non-application of mind. *Maru Ram* confirms that Article 72 is exercised on binding ministerial advice.

PYQ 8 - 2025 GS-II Q3

Question: Compare and contrast the President's power to pardon in India and in the USA. Are there any limits to it in both countries? What are "preemptive pardons"? (150 words, 10 marks)

Model answer: Article 72 vests India's President with pardon, reprieve, respite, remission and commutation for Union-field offences, court-martial cases and every death sentence. The power is exercised on binding Council of Ministers advice (*Maru Ram*), may reassess merits (*Kehar Singh*) and is reviewable on narrow grounds such as mala fides, arbitrariness and non-application of mind (*Epuru Sudhakar*).

The US President's Article II power is personal rather than ministerially advised and extends to federal offences. It cannot cover State offences or cases of impeachment. Both powers are constitutionally broad but not legally limitless.

A US preemptive pardon covers completed conduct before charge, trial or conviction; it cannot license a future offence. India should not automatically import that doctrine because Article 72 operates within parliamentary government, ministerial responsibility and Indian review doctrine.

Thus, both are safety valves, but India's clemency is government-advised and reviewable, whereas the US model concentrates responsibility in the elected President.

Original solved Mains practice

M1. "The Indian President is a constitutional sentinel, not an alternative executive." Examine. (10 marks, 150 words)

Model answer: Articles 53 and 74 create a deliberate duality: Union executive power is formally vested in the President, but is exercised on binding ministerial advice. The 42nd Amendment made advice expressly binding; the 44th permits one reconsideration, after which reiterated advice controls.

Therefore, in ordinary majority government the President cannot pursue an independent policy. Yet the office is not empty. Article 78 supports consultation and information; assent and reconsideration can force reflection; hung Lok Sabhas create bounded choices in appointing a Prime Minister; and disputed confidence must be tested on the floor. K. R. Narayanan's return of President's-Rule advice illustrates warning without final defiance.

Thus, the President protects constitutional process through questions, reasons and carefully bounded delay. The office is a sentinel because it preserves rules, but not an alternative executive because democratic responsibility remains with the Council of Ministers.

M2. Explain how the presidential election reconciles popular representation with federal balance. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer: India avoids both hereditary headship and direct presidential rivalry. Articles 54-55 create an indirectly elected President whose electoral college contains elected MPs and elected State, Delhi and Puducherry MLAs.

Popular representation enters because every elector is elected, while nominated members and MLCs are excluded. Federal balance enters through weighted MLA votes based on the 1971 population-to-elected-seat ratio. This creates relative uniformity within each State and comparative weight among States. The total MLA vote value is then divided across elected MPs of both Houses, seeking parity between the States collectively and Parliament collectively. PR-STV and secret preference voting require a winner to cross a majority quota rather than merely lead a fragmented field.

The design has limits: its arithmetic is complex, the 1971 freeze no longer reflects current population distribution, and indirect election weakens immediate public visibility. Yet automatic use of present population could penalise States that controlled population growth, while direct election could create a rival executive mandate.

The system therefore represents a constitutional compromise: democratic but mediated, national but federal, and majoritarian only after transferable preferences.

M3. Critically examine the President's veto powers after the 2025 Article 143 opinion on assent. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer: Article 111 allows assent, withholding and one return of a non-Money Bill. Re-passage binds the President. A Money Bill cannot be returned, while assent to a constitutional amendment is obligatory. Textual silence on time creates the pocket-veto possibility.

For a Governor-reserved State Bill, Article 201 permits assent, withholding or direction to return a non-Money Bill; unlike Article 111, State re-passage does not expressly bind the President. This can protect national constitutional concerns but also prolong federal uncertainty.

The Supreme Court's 20 November 2025 Article 143 opinion rejected rigid judicial timelines and automatic deemed assent, reasoning that courts cannot add constitutional consequences. Yet it did not constitutionalise indefinite inertia: glaring, prolonged and unexplained inaction remains open to limited intervention requiring a decision.

The opinion preserves separation of powers but shifts responsibility toward transparent constitutional conduct. Pocket veto should therefore be treated as a narrow consequence of text, not a routine political weapon. Reasons, expedition and parliamentary/federal accountability are preferable to either executive silence or judicial rewriting.

M4. Ordinance power is necessary for urgency but dangerous as a substitute for Parliament. Discuss. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer: Article 123 permits temporary legislation when both Houses are not simultaneously in session and immediate action is necessary. An ordinance has Act-like force, can amend a Central Act and operate retrospectively, but cannot exceed Parliament's competence, abridge Fundamental Rights or amend the Constitution.

Necessity supports the power: crises and legal gaps may arise between sittings. Democratic danger arises because promulgation precedes debate, committee scrutiny and bicameral approval. Re-promulgation can convert an emergency bridge into executive legislation.

The Constitution therefore requires laying before both Houses and makes the ordinance cease six weeks after the later reassembly date or earlier disapproval. *D. C. Wadhwa* called routine re-promulgation a fraud on the Constitution. *Krishna Kumar Singh* made laying mandatory, reaffirmed review and rejected automatic survival of benefits from every lapsed ordinance.

The appropriate response is not abolition but constitutional discipline: reasons demonstrating urgency, prompt parliamentary scrutiny, committee review and refusal to re-promulgate except on genuinely new circumstances. The power is valid when it bridges time; it becomes abusive when it bypasses representation.

M5. Compare the pardoning powers of the President and Governor and explain their judicial limits. (10 marks, 150 words)

Model answer: Article 72 empowers the President to grant pardon, reprieve, respite, remission or commutation in court-martial cases, Union-field offences and every death sentence. Article 161 gives the Governor corresponding authority over State-field offences but no court-martial power and no power to pardon a death sentence, though the Governor may suspend, remit or commute it.

Neither is personal mercy. *Maru Ram* binds both to ministerial advice. *Kehar Singh* allows executive reconsideration of merits without converting the President into an appellate court. *Epuru Sudhakar* permits limited judicial review for mala fides, arbitrariness, non-application of mind and relevant-material defects.

Thus, clemency is broader than ordinary adjudication but not above constitutionalism: jurisdiction differs, elected governments bear responsibility, and courts police the integrity rather than the merits of mercy.

M6. Evaluate the neutrality challenge facing the Vice-President as Chairman of Rajya Sabha. (10 marks, 150 words)

Model answer: Article 64 makes the Vice-President ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha, a chamber representing States and revising national legislation. The Chairman maintains order, interprets rules, controls admissibility under House procedure, uses a casting vote under Article 100 and decides Rajya Sabha defection cases under the Tenth Schedule.

Neutrality is difficult because the Vice-President emerges from a political election while rulings affect government-opposition competition. Speaking opportunities, disciplinary action and timing of defection decisions can alter parliamentary outcomes. Legal safeguards include absence of a first vote, judicial review of Tenth Schedule decisions and Article 92's bar on presiding/voting during the Chair's own removal motion.

Yet law cannot manufacture trust. Consistent precedents, reasoned rulings and balanced enforcement are essential. The Chairman's formal power secures order; perceived impartiality secures legitimacy.

M7. Distinguish vacancy and removal rules for the President and Vice-President. Why do the differences matter? (10 marks, 150 words)

Model answer: The President is impeached under Article 61 for violation of the Constitution: either House may initiate, one-fourth must sign, 14 days' notice applies and both Houses require two-thirds of total membership. A presidential casual vacancy must be filled within six months; the Vice-President acts meanwhile.

The Vice-President is removed by a Rajya Sabha resolution passed by a majority of all then members and agreed to by Lok Sabha. Only Rajya Sabha initiates, no ground is stated and the process is not impeachment. A Vice-Presidential casual vacancy is filled as soon as possible, without a six-month textual deadline; the successor receives a fresh five-year term.

The differences track function: presidential removal protects the Head of State through a very high threshold, while Rajya Sabha leads removal of its own presiding officer. The 2025 transition to C. P. Radhakrishnan illustrates Article 68's prompt-election rule.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Skipping this Part does not reduce answer completeness. Use it for deeper evaluation, comparison and interview-level refinement.

A1. Why the President is neither ruler nor rubber stamp

- [ANALYSIS] "Rubber stamp" is too strong because constitutional form can delay, warn and force reconsideration; "independent executive" is equally wrong because reiterated advice binds.
- [ANALYSIS] Bagehot's rights - to be consulted, to encourage and to warn - illuminate the office, but Indian answers must anchor them in Articles 74 and 78 rather than importing convention as text.
- [ANALYSIS] The office has maximum leverage where democratic authorization is least clear: hung Houses, contested confidence, caretaker situations and questionable dissolution advice.
- [LIMIT] Leverage is not policy autonomy. The President cannot substitute a preferred programme for the elected ministry's.

A2. Election method follows office design: India and France

Dimension	India	France
System	Parliamentary republic	Semi-presidential Fifth Republic
President's normal role	Nominal Head of State	Politically powerful executive actor
Electorate	Indirect federal electoral college	Direct universal adult suffrage
Voting	Weighted PR-STV, secret ballot	Two-round majority election
Majority method	Transfer lower preferences until quota	Absolute majority first round; top two contest second if needed
Mandate	Federal-symbolic and mediated	Direct nationwide personal mandate
Risk	Indirectness can appear remote	Dual legitimacy/cohabitation can divide executive authority

- [ANALYSIS] India's mechanism prevents a rival popular executive mandate and represents federal units.
- [ANALYSIS] France's mechanism legitimises a strong President but may generate tension with a parliamentary majority of another political camp.
- [VERDICT] The procedures are not competing election technologies in isolation; each matches a different constitutional job description.

A3. India and USA: pardon power

Dimension	India	United States
Text	Article 72	Article II, Section 2
Office type	Nominal executive	Real presidential executive
Advice	Binding Council of Ministers	Personal presidential power
Jurisdiction	Union field, court-martial, death sentence	Federal offences against United States
Express limits	Constitutional field; advice and review	Cannot pardon impeachment; no State offences
Judicial control	Limited review of decision-making defects	Very broad power; constitutional limits remain
Pre-emptive pardon	Do not mechanically import US doctrine	Completed conduct may be pardoned before charge/conviction; not future conduct

- [ANALYSIS] Both systems treat clemency as a safety valve, but accountability differs: parliamentary ministerial responsibility in India versus direct presidential political responsibility in the USA.
- [LIMIT] "Pre-emptive" does not mean authorization of a future crime.

A4. Ordinances and democratic legitimacy

- [ANALYSIS] Necessity argument: crises and immediate legal gaps may arise between sittings.
- [ANALYSIS] Abuse argument: the executive can bypass debate, committee scrutiny and an unfavourable second chamber.
- [ANALYSIS] Constitutional settlement: temporary force, mandatory laying, legislative disapproval, judicial review and anti-re-promulgation.
- [LIMIT] Courts police constitutional abuse but cannot replace Parliament's political duty to scrutinise ordinances promptly.

A5. Veto, assent delay and constitutional time

- [ANALYSIS] A pocket veto is a consequence of textual silence, not a separately enumerated power.
- [ANALYSIS] Delay can preserve deliberative space but can also become an unaccountable veto through inertia.
- [CURRENT] The 2025 Article 143 opinion rejected rigid court-made clocks and deemed assent while retaining limited review of glaring unexplained delay.
- [VERDICT] The sound reform direction is transparent reasons and constitutional expedition, not judicial rewriting of an absent deadline.

A6. Clemency as mercy, public power and rule of law

- [ANALYSIS] Clemency corrects exceptional harshness, accounts for post-conviction developments and permits public-policy mercy.
- [ANALYSIS] Because it alters a judicially imposed consequence, reasons/material must not be caste-, religion-, status- or politics-driven.
- [ANALYSIS] Limited review respects separation of powers: courts inspect the integrity of the process rather than retrying clemency merits.

A7. Chairmanship, federal deliberation and neutrality

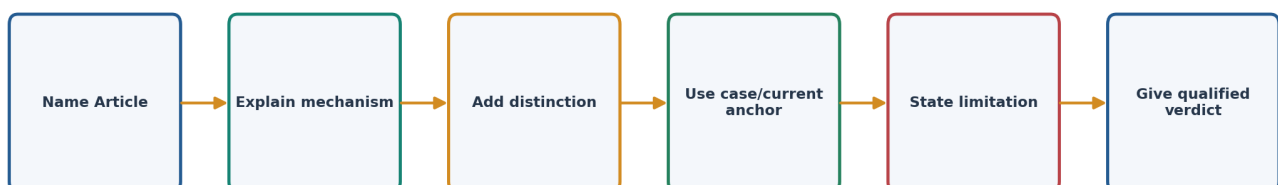
- [ANALYSIS] The Vice-President is elected nationally by Parliament but presides over the chamber designed to represent States; this creates a permanent neutrality test.
- [ANALYSIS] Agenda rulings, speaking opportunities, disciplinary action and anti-defection timing can affect substantive political outcomes.
- [ANALYSIS] Legal review catches some defects; daily legitimacy still depends on consistent procedure and reasoned rulings.
- [VERDICT] The Chair's strongest authority is reputational: opposition compliance rises when procedure appears even-handed.

A8. Reform matrix

Issue	Reform-compatible response	Constitutional caution
Hung-House discretion	Published order of preference and immediate floor test	Do not freeze all political contingencies
Assent delay	Reasons, tracking and constitutional expedition	No invented deemed assent after 2025 opinion
Ordinance overuse	Prompt committee/parliamentary scrutiny	Urgency power remains constitutionally valid
Mercy delay	Time-bound administration and full records	Final decision remains executive on advice
Chair neutrality	Reasoned rulings and predictable rule enforcement	House autonomy and judicial limits remain
VP vacancy	Prompt notified election	Article 68 has no six-month text

A9. Mains answer architecture

President-Vice-President answer spine



A high-scoring answer connects provision, mechanism, distinction, evidence and a bounded verdict.

President as rubber stamp

1. Define nominal executive through Articles 53/74.
2. State 42nd binding-advice and 44th reconsideration rules.
3. Separate normal rule from hung-House situational discretion.
4. Use K. R. Narayanan as a reconsideration example.
5. Bound discretion by Lok Sabha confidence and judicially reviewable constitutionalism.
6. Conclude: dormant in normal politics, consequential at constitutional margins.

Ordinance answer

1. Article 123 purpose.
2. Preconditions and legislative competence.

3. Six-week/laying/disapproval controls.
4. *Wadhwa and Krishna Kumar Singh*.
5. Necessity versus bypass criticism.
6. Conclude with legislative scrutiny, not abolition.

Vice-President as Chairman

1. Article 64 thesis: regular role is presiding.
2. Rule/order/casting-vote powers.
3. Tenth Schedule tribunal and review.
4. Speaker distinctions.
5. Neutrality/federal-chamber challenge.
6. Conclude that impartiality converts authority into legitimacy.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Constitutional identity

- President: Articles 52-62, 72, 74; nominal Head of State.
- Vice-President: Articles 63-71; ex-officio Rajya Sabha Chairman.
- President acts on binding ministerial advice; may return advice once.
- VP is not an automatic successor for the unexpired presidential term.

President election

- College: elected LS + elected RS + elected State/Delhi/Puducherry MLAs.
- Excluded: nominated MPs/MLAs, all MLCs, J&K UT MLAs.
- MLA value: 1971 population divided by elected MLAs and 1000; rounding rule.
- MP value: total MLA vote value divided by elected MPs of both Houses.
- Same MP value across Houses.
- PR-STV, secret ranked ballot, majority quota and preference transfer.
- 50 proposers + 50 seconders; statutory deposit.
- Supreme Court finally decides disputes.
- Electoral-college vacancy does not invalidate election.
- Acts before election is voided remain valid.

President qualification and tenure

- Citizen; 35; qualified for Lok Sabha; no office of profit.
- Oath: CJI/senior-most available SC judge.
- Five years; continues until successor; unlimited re-election.
- Resigns to VP.
- Casual vacancy election within six months; successor gets fresh five years.
- Dr Rajendra Prasad alone completed two terms.

Impeachment and immunity

- Ground: violation of Constitution.
- Either House starts; one-fourth signs; 14-day notice.
- Two-thirds of total membership in both Houses.
- Nominated MPs participate; MLAs do not.
- President may appear/be represented in investigation.
- No President impeached.
- Article 361: official non-answerability; no criminal case/arrest during term; two-month notice for personal civil claim.

Position and discretion

- Article 53 form; Articles 74-75 parliamentary reality.
- 42nd: advice binding; 44th: return once, reiterated advice binding.
- Situational spaces: hung-House PM, floor-confidence demand, ministry refusing to resign, dissolution where alternative exists.
- No general personal policy discretion.
- Narayanan 1997/1998: President's-Rule advice returned.

Powers

- Executive: appointments, Article 77 form, Article 78 information.
- Legislative: summon/prorogue, dissolve LS, addresses/messages, joint sitting, 12 RS nominations, assent/ordinance.
- Financial: recommendations, Budget, grants, Finance Commission, Contingency Fund.
- Judicial: judges, Article 143 advice, Article 72.
- Diplomatic/military: formal international authority, Supreme Commander.
- Emergency: Articles 352, 356, 360 under separate safeguards.

Veto

- Ordinary: assent/withhold/return once; re-passage binds.
- Money: assent/withhold; cannot return.
- Amendment: assent obligatory.
- Pocket: no fixed Article 111 deadline.
- Article 201 State bill: State repassage does not override President.
- 2025 opinion: no rigid judicial timeline/deemed assent; glaring unexplained delay remains reviewable for direction to decide.

Ordinance

- Available unless both Houses are in session.
- Immediate action; same force as Act; within Parliament competence.
- Can amend Central Act and be retrospective.
- Cannot abridge FRs or amend Constitution.
- Lay before both Houses; ends six weeks after later reassembly or earlier disapproval/withdrawal.
- *Cooper*: review; *Wadhwa*: re-promulgation fraud; *Krishna Kumar Singh*: mandatory laying and no automatic enduring rights.

Pardon

- Pardon, reprieve, respite, remission, commutation.
- President: court-martial, Union-field offences, every death sentence.
- Governor: State field; cannot pardon death or touch court-martial; may suspend/remit/commute death.
- *Maru Ram*: advice.
- *Kehar Singh*: merits can be reconsidered.
- *Epuru Sudhakar*: limited review.
- US pre-emptive pardon: completed conduct before charge/conviction, never future crime.

Vice-President

- College: all elected + nominated MPs; no MLAs.
- PR-STV, secret ballot, equal votes.
- Citizen; 35; qualified for Rajya Sabha.
- 20 proposers + 20 seconders.
- Oath by President/person appointed.
- Five years; resigns to President.
- Removal: RS effective majority, LS agreement, 14 days, no ground, not impeachment.
- Casual vacancy: election as soon as possible, no six-month text, fresh five-year term.
- C. P. Radhakrishnan: elected 9 Sep 2025, entered office 12 Sep 2025.

Chairman and acting role

- Not RS member; no first vote; casting vote on tie.
- Maintains order, rules on procedure, Tenth Schedule tribunal subject to review.
- Does not certify Money Bills.
- During own removal: cannot preside; may speak; cannot vote.
- Acting as President: does not chair RS; Deputy Chairman performs duties.

Final 15 traps

1. Nominated MPs: VP election yes; President election no; impeachment yes.
2. MLAs: President election yes; VP election/impeachment no.
3. MLCs: neither election.
4. Delhi/Puducherry MLAs included for President; J&K UT MLAs not included.
5. President qualifies for LS; VP for RS.
6. President oath by CJI; VP oath by President.
7. President casual vacancy within six months; VP as soon as possible.
8. VP successor gets fresh term; does not finish predecessor's term.
9. Ordinary Bill returnable; Money Bill not; amendment assent mandatory.
10. Article 111 has no fixed deadline.
11. Ordinance possible if even one House is not in session.
12. Ordinance cannot amend Constitution/abridge FR.
13. Governor cannot pardon death but may commute it.
14. VP removal is not impeachment.
15. Acting VP cannot simultaneously chair Rajya Sabha.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/9: Two offices and the parliamentary executive design

PRESIDENT: ARTICLES 52-62, 72, 74
constitutional Head of State + formal Union executive power + national continuity

VICE-PRESIDENT: ARTICLES 63-71
ex officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha + constitutional reserve for presidential vacancy

PARLIAMENTARY LOGIC
President ordinarily acts on ministerial advice
Vice-President ordinarily works inside Parliament

CURRENT DATED CONTROL: 24 AUGUST 2026
Droupadi Murmu -> President
C. P. Radhakrishnan -> Vice-President and Rajya Sabha Chairman.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/9: Presidential election, vote value and dispute route

ELECTORAL COLLEGE: ARTICLE 54
elected MPs + elected MLAs of States + elected MLAs of Delhi and Puducherry
exclude nominated MPs, nominated MLAs and State Legislative Council members

WEIGHTING: ARTICLE 55
MLA vote value -> 1971 census population / elected Assembly strength / 1000
MP vote value -> total MLA vote value / elected MPs

COUNT
proportional representation by single transferable vote + secret ballot

DISPUTE
Article 71 -> Supreme Court; vacancy does not invalidate the election.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/9: Qualifications, oath, tenure, vacancy and removal

PRESIDENT
citizen + 35 years + qualified for Lok Sabha + no office of profit
oath before Chief Justice of India / senior-most available Supreme Court judge
five-year term; re-election allowed; continues until successor enters office
casual vacancy election within six months

IMPEACHMENT: ARTICLE 61
either House starts -> 14-day notice -> one-fourth signatures
-> two-thirds of total membership in each House -> violation of Constitution

ARTICLE 361
official-act immunity and procedural protection do not create substantive impunity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/9: Aid and advice, reconsideration and bounded discretion

ARTICLE 74
Council of Ministers with PM at head aids and advises the President
President may require reconsideration once
reconsidered advice binds
court cannot inquire into what advice was tendered

SITUATIONAL CHOICE
hung Lok Sabha -> identify person most likely to command confidence
outgoing ministry -> continuity until an alternative is formed

NOT PERSONAL POLICY POWER
Shamsher Singh (1974): constitutional head operates through responsible government.

ANSWER VERDICT
the office can warn, encourage and require reconsideration, not create a rival executive.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/9: Seven presidential power clusters

EXECUTIVE -> appointments, Rules of Business, administration in President's name
LEGISLATIVE -> summon, prorogue, dissolve LS, address, nominate, assent
FINANCIAL -> recommendation routes, Budget presentation, Finance Commission
JUDICIAL -> Article 72 clemency + Article 143 reference
DIPLOMATIC -> credentials and treaty form, subject to constitutional law
MILITARY -> Supreme Commander in constitutional form
EMERGENCY -> Articles 352, 356 and 360 on constitutional advice

CONTROL
formal breadth is ordinarily exercised through ministerial responsibility and review.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/9: Veto and ordinance: the executive-legislative interface

ARTICLE 111

ordinary Bill -> assent / withhold / return once
repassed ordinary Bill -> assent required
Money Bill -> cannot be returned
Constitution Amendment Bill -> assent required
pocket veto -> no textual decision deadline for Union Bills

ARTICLE 123

Parliament not both in session + immediate action necessary
-> ordinance has force of Act -> laid before Parliament
-> ceases six weeks after reassembly unless replaced / disapproved / withdrawn

CASE CONTROL

D.C. Wadhwa (1986) and Krishna Kumar Singh (2017) reject routine re-promulgation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/9: Article 72 clemency and the Governor comparison

FIVE FORMS

pardon | reprieve | respite | remission | commutation

PRESIDENT: ARTICLE 72

court-martial cases
offences against Union executive field
all death-sentence cases

GOVERNOR: ARTICLE 161

State executive field; cannot pardon a court-martial
death sentence may be suspended, remitted or commuted, not pardoned under Article 161

RULE-OF-LAW CONTROL

ministerial advice + limited review for mala fides, arbitrariness or irrelevant material.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/9: Vice-President: election, removal, Chair and acting role

ELECTION

members of both Houses, elected and nominated; State legislatures excluded

REMOVAL

Rajya Sabha resolution by majority of all then members
-> agreed by Lok Sabha -> 14-day notice
not impeachment; no 'violation of Constitution' ground is required

CHAIRMAN

procedure, discipline and casting vote; no ordinary first vote
Tenth Schedule adjudication is reviewable; own-removal debate uses special arrangement

ACTING PRESIDENT

discharges presidential functions during vacancy / inability; separate office rules apply.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/9: Conventions, cases, traps and the answer spine

CASE / CONVENTION ROUTES

Shamsher Singh (1974) -> constitutional head
Kehar Singh (1988) / Maru Ram (1980) -> clemency on advice with bounded review
Krishna Kumar Singh (2017) -> ordinance limits
hung House -> confidence, not personal preference

PRELIMS FIREWALL

President and Vice-President colleges are different
President impeachment != Vice-President removal
six-month vacancy rule applies to President, not Vice-President
Money Bill cannot be returned; Amendment Bill requires assent

MAINS SPINE

constitutional position -> exact power -> advice/procedure -> case -> bounded discretion
-> accountability -> sentinel without a rival popular mandate.